

NFL Best Ball 2026

Team-by-Team Review — All 32 Teams, Layer by Layer

Compiled June 17, 2026

Grounded in the toolkit data layers: nflfastR 2024–25 play-by-play · Clay-2026 projected team volume · compositional Monte-Carlo ceiling sim · PBP-fit correlation structure · the real 2026 schedule · the Apr–May coachspeak/film corpus.

How to read this

What this is. A best-ball review of every NFL team for 2026, walking each analytical layer in turn rather than just listing players. Teams are ordered by their best board asset, so the loaded offenses come first; the Free-Agent bucket (unsigned in this snapshot) is last.

The layers. Volume & script — Clay-2026 projected team pass/run volume, pace and implied scoring, each ranked 1-32. Usage & opportunity — 2025 nflfastR play-by-play: target share (with week-to-week stability), aDOT, carries, receptions and the best single-week DK total. Ceiling & upside — the Monte-Carlo p95 single-week ceiling and spike-week rate (the best-ball currency). Regular-season value — simulated advancement (the top-2-of-12 grind). Stacking & the Week 17 finals — the QB-WR1 ($r \approx 0.35$) and bring-back ($r \approx 0.13$) correlation math, plus the real W17 game and its blow-up "tail" rank. 2026 outlook — what changes this year: the 2025→2026 projection deltas per player, the share of last season's target volume that has turned over, veteran arrivals and rookies, and (where the spring corpus discusses it) new-coordinator/scheme notes. Coachspeak & film — verbatim beat-writer and film notes that survived the per-player filter. Best-ball plan & Risks — the synthesis: anchor, correlated pieces, board-vs-ADP values, and the flags.

Caveats. 2025 usage is descriptive, not predictive — players who changed teams or are rookies carry no usage and are flagged as projection. The sim ceiling is an ordering, not a literal probability. The Free-Agent group reflects talent, not opportunity, until they sign. The coachspeak corpus is a spring 2026 snapshot. Coordinator/scheme notes appear only where the spring corpus mentions them (about a quarter of teams) — this is not a complete coaching database, and 2026 coordinators are never asserted from memory. All figures come from the data files (grounded), not from memory.

Contents

Detroit Lions (DET)

Bye W6 • Playoffs: W15 MIN • W16 NYG • W17 CHI@DET (finals tail #4) • 4 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A balanced, high-volume attack and a top scoring offense (2.94 implied TD/g, 3rd). 4 alpha-ceiling players (p95≥33); best board asset is Jahmyr Gibbs at #1.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
1	Jahmyr Gibbs	RB	1.2	46	16.3%	100%	16.2% tgt
7	Amon-Ra St. Brown	WR	7.9	45	15.7%	98%	31.7% tgt
54	Jameson Williams	WR	50.5	33	18.6%	83%	18.6% tgt
95	Sam LaPorta	TE	92.4	29	18.7%	90%	18.5% tgt
99	Jared Goff	QB	103.5	34	16.2%	59%	1.1 car/g
147	Isiah Pacheco	RB	142.2	20	21.0%	52%	9.8% tgt
175	Isaac TeSlaa	WR	169.3	14	23.6%	39%	5.7% tgt
386	Greg Dortch	WR	228.6	3	14.1%	4%	8.2% tgt

Volume & script

59.8 plays/g (9th) • 32.0 pass att (15th) • 53.5% pass rate (19th) • 247.5 pass yds (4th) • 27.8 carries (10th) • 126.1 rush yds (10th) • 2.94 TD/g (3rd)

A balanced script (53.5% pass) spreads opportunity without a strong structural lean either way, and the pace is real — 59.8 snaps/g (9th) manufactures extra possessions for everyone. Most important for best ball: 2.94 implied TD/g (3rd) is a top-tier scoring environment that raises every weekly ceiling.

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

Amon-Ra St. Brown 31.7% tgt / aDOT 8.1 / max 44.4 • Jameson Williams 18.6% tgt / aDOT 12.6 / max 29.9 • Sam LaPorta 18.5% tgt / aDOT 5.7 / max 21.7 • Jahmyr Gibbs 14.3 car/g, 4.5 rec/g, max 58.4

Amon-Ra St. Brown is the focal point — a 31.7% target share in 2025 (fairly stable, cv 0.35), at a 8.1-yard aDOT (all-levels routes), peaking at 44.4 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Jameson Williams (18.6%), Sam LaPorta (18.5%). In the backfield Jahmyr Gibbs profiled as the lead of a rotation (14.3 carries/g, and he caught 4.5 balls/g); ceiling week 58.4 DK. Small-sample caveat: Sam LaPorta (9g) missed time, so the rates ride a partial season.

2026 outlook: what changes

Volume shift: Clay projects 32.0 pass att/g in 2026 vs 36.5 actual in 2025 (-4.5) — projected for lower pass volume / more run than 2025. Vacated opportunity: ~14.8% of the 2025 target volume turned over (a largely intact target tree) — out: K.Raymond (5.5%, to CHI), D.Montgomery (5.3%, to HOU), B.Wright (4.0%, gone). In: Isiah Pacheco (from KC); Greg Dortch (from ARI). Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): Jahmyr Gibbs 21.3/g proj vs 22.3/g in 2025 (-1.0, roughly steady); Amon-Ra St. Brown 19.0/g proj vs 19.9/g in 2025 (-0.9, roughly steady); Jameson Williams 12.6/g proj vs 13.6/g in 2025 (-1.0, roughly steady); Sam LaPorta 11.0/g proj vs 11.9/g in 2025 (-0.9, roughly steady).

Ceiling & upside

Jahmyr Gibbs p95 46 (16.3% spike) • Amon-Ra St. Brown p95 45 (15.7% spike) • Jared Goff p95 34 (16.2% spike) • Jameson Williams p95 33 (18.6% spike)

4 players clear the alpha-ceiling bar, led by Jahmyr Gibbs (p95 46, hits a spike week 16.3% of the time). This is the currency that wins best ball — these are the weekly outcomes that drag a lineup into the 90th percentile. Highest-variance (boom/bust) of the group: Jameson Williams — exactly the volatility you want on a bench that only counts its best weeks.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: Jahmyr Gibbs (100%), Amon-Ra St. Brown (98%), Sam LaPorta (90%).

Pure spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): Isiah Pacheco, Isaac TeSlaa — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Jared Goff + Amon-Ra St. Brown / Jameson Williams — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r \approx 0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is CHI@DET — a top-tier blow-up game (tail rank #4); the natural bring-back is a CHI pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byses fall in Week 6, and the playoff run is W15 vs MIN, W16 vs NYG.

Coachspeak & film

On Jahmyr Gibbs: “Didn’t understand why Bijan Robinson opened as the 1.1 in ADP over Jahmyr Gibbs” (@adamlevitan). On Jared Goff: “What we need to see in the coming years, and I think what we can see, and he’s got the coach to do it, who had Jared Goff playing like a machine” (@benjaminsolak). On Isiah Pacheco: “Can’t stop drafting Isiah Pacheco in best ball” (@ihartitz).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around Jahmyr Gibbs (board #1, ADP 1.2), with Amon-Ra St. Brown, Jameson Williams as the correlated ceiling pieces. Let the market overpay for Greg Dortch.

Risks & flags

No specific risk overlays on this group; the main risk is generic (price vs the field).

Los Angeles Rams (LAR)

Bye W11 • Playoffs: W15 DAL • W16 SEA • W17 LAR@TB (finals tail #1) • 4 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A balanced, high-volume attack and a top scoring offense (3.24 implied TD/g, 1st). 4 alpha-ceiling players (p95≥33); best board asset is Puka Nacua at #2.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
2	Puka Nacua	WR	4.0	50	15.8%	100%	31.1% tgt
34	Kyren Williams	RB	29.3	34	18.2%	83%	8.4% tgt
43	Davante Adams	WR	46.2	35	17.9%	88%	24.4% tgt
82	Matthew Stafford	QB	88.5	37	16.2%	79%	1.7 car/g
107	Blake Corum	RB	100.5	23	20.4%	56%	5.2% tgt
205	Colby Parkinson	TE	203.3	14	26.7%	33%	11.8% tgt
214	Terrance Ferguson	TE	212.3	21	20.2%	56%	7.2% tgt
248	Jarquez Hunter	RB	230.0				rookie/NA
322	Max Klare	TE	228.9	2	12.2%	2%	rookie/NA

Volume & script

60.1 plays/g (7th) • 32.8 pass att (11th) • 54.7% pass rate (13th) • 251.9 pass yds (2nd) • 27.2 carries (15th) • 121.5 rush yds (13th) • 3.24 TD/g (1st)

A balanced script (54.7% pass) spreads opportunity without a strong structural lean either way, and the pace is real — 60.1 snaps/g (7th) manufactures extra possessions for everyone. Most important for best ball: 3.24 implied TD/g (1st) is a top-tier scoring environment that raises every weekly ceiling.

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

Puka Nacua 31.1% tgt / aDOT 10.1 / max 49.5 • Davante Adams 24.4% tgt / aDOT 13.2 / max 26.5 • Colby Parkinson 11.8% tgt / aDOT 5.1 / max 24.5 • Kyren Williams 15.2 car/g, 2.2 rec/g, max 32.1

Puka Nacua (2025 with LAR) is the focal point — a 31.1% target share in 2025 (rock-steady, cv 0.27), at a 10.1-yard aDOT (all-levels routes), peaking at 49.5 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Davante Adams (24.4%). In the backfield Kyren Williams (2025 with LAR) profiled as a true workhorse (15.2 carries/g, with a thin receiving role); ceiling week 32.1 DK.

2026 outlook: what changes

In: Puka Nacua (from LAR); Kyren Williams (from LAR); Davante Adams (from LAR); Matthew Stafford (from LAR); Blake Corum (from LAR); Colby Parkinson (from LAR). Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): Puka Nacua 21.1/g proj vs 25.1/g in 2025 (-4.0, projected to regress, joins from LAR); Kyren Williams 14.5/g proj vs 16.3/g in 2025 (-1.8, roughly steady, joins from LAR); Davante Adams 13.9/g proj vs 15.4/g in 2025 (-1.5, roughly steady, joins from LAR); Matthew Stafford 18.3/g proj vs 22.0/g in 2025 (-3.7, projected to regress, joins from LAR).

Ceiling & upside

Puka Nacua p95 50 (15.8% spike) • Matthew Stafford p95 37 (16.2% spike) • Davante Adams p95 35 (17.9% spike) • Kyren Williams p95 34 (18.2% spike)

4 players clear the alpha-ceiling bar, led by Puka Nacua (p95 50, hits a spike week 15.8% of the time). This is the currency that wins best ball — these are the weekly outcomes that drag a lineup into the 90th percentile. Highest-variance (boom/bust) of the group: Davante Adams — exactly the volatility you want on a bench that only counts its best weeks.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: Puka Nacua (100%), Davante Adams (88%), Kyren Williams (83%). Pure spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): Blake Corum, Colby Parkinson, Terrance Ferguson — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Matthew Stafford + Puka Nacua / Davante Adams — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r \approx 0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is LAR@TB — a top-tier blow-up game (tail rank #1); the natural bring-back is a TB pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byes fall in Week 11, and the playoff run is W15 vs DAL, W16 vs SEA.

Coachspeak & film

On the team: “He’s going to not be in the slot, not be in the backfield in this kind of unique spot where the way that the Rams want to play this defense is going to be a box”. On Matthew Stafford: “For the Rams, an injury to Matthew Stafford, who is 38 years old, at the quarterback position would certainly derail their season” (@thepowerrank). On Blake Corum: “Blake Corum will be a very important handcuff with standalone value in 2026” (@supernova38). On Colby Parkinson: “Colby Parkinson’s, I think really actually a pretty solid player for him” (@joshnorris).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around Puka Nacua (board #2, ADP 4.0), with Kyren Williams, Davante Adams as the correlated ceiling pieces. Let the market overpay for Jarquez Hunter, Max Klare.

Risks & flags

Puka Nacua — risk: Open NFL off-field review; early-season tail risk (survivable phase). 11 • Davante Adams — age: Age / role-decline flag (dataroma model). 11 • Blake Corum — trap: Trap take Jaxson Dart instead (+23 board ranks). 4.2

Cincinnati Bengals (CIN)

Bye W6 · Playoffs: W15 CAR · W16 IND · W17 BAL@CIN (finals tail #2) · 3 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A pass-first, high-volume attack and a top scoring offense (2.76 implied TD/g, 4th). 3 alpha-ceiling players (p95≥33); best board asset is Ja'Marr Chase at #3.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
3	Ja'Marr Chase	WR	3.2	47	16.0%	99%	32.0% tgt
22	Chase Brown	RB	17.8	35	17.4%	85%	14.4% tgt
42	Tee Higgins	WR	36.2	33	18.8%	85%	18.3% tgt
53	Joe Burrow	QB	57.4	30	7.4%	85%	1.8 car/g
217	Mike Gesicki	TE	216.9	19	21.3%	48%	10.5% tgt
236	Samaje Perine	RB	225.6	17	21.8%	47%	5.6% tgt
282	Tahj Brooks	RB	231.1	6	17.6%	6%	3.0% tgt
311	Joe Flacco	QB	228.8			3%	1.6 car/g
313	Andrei Iosivas	WR	228.6	15	23.3%	40%	10.1% tgt

Volume & script

60.3 plays/g (3rd) · 34.9 pass att (1st) · 58.0% pass rate (2nd) · 252.0 pass yds (1st) · 25.4 carries (30th) · 108.2 rush yds (31st) · 2.76 TD/g (4th)

This is a genuinely pass-first script — 58.0% pass rate against a 54% league mean — so the receiving corps, not the backfield, is where the fantasy points concentrate, and the pace is real — 60.3 snaps/g (3rd) manufactures extra possessions for everyone. Most important for best ball: 2.76 implied TD/g (4th) is a top-tier scoring environment that raises every weekly ceiling.

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

Ja'Marr Chase 32.0% tgt / aDOT 8.5 / max 41.1 · Tee Higgins 18.3% tgt / aDOT 13.3 / max 34.1 · Mike Gesicki 10.5% tgt / aDOT 9.7 / max 20.6 · Chase Brown 13.7 car/g, 4.1 rec/g, max 32.9

Ja'Marr Chase is the focal point — a 32.0% target share in 2025 (fairly stable, cv 0.35), at a 8.5-yard aDOT (all-levels routes), peaking at 41.1 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Tee Higgins (18.3%). In the backfield Chase Brown profiled as the lead of a rotation (13.7 carries/g, and he caught 4.1 balls/g); ceiling week 32.9 DK. Small-sample caveat: Joe Burrow (8g) missed time, so the rates ride a partial season.

2026 outlook: what changes

Volume shift: Clay projects 34.9 pass att/g in 2026 vs 40.0 actual in 2025 (-5.1) — projected for lower pass volume / more run than 2025. Vacated opportunity: ~6.7% of the 2025 target volume turned over (a largely intact target tree) — out: N.Fant (6.7%, to NO). Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): Ja'Marr Chase 19.9/g proj vs 21.0/g in 2025 (-1.1, roughly steady); Chase Brown 16.0/g proj vs 16.9/g in 2025 (-0.9, roughly steady); Tee Higgins 12.7/g proj vs 14.2/g in 2025 (-1.5, roughly steady); Joe Burrow 18.6/g proj vs 18.1/g in 2025 (+0.5, roughly steady).

Ceiling & upside

Ja'Marr Chase p95 47 (16.0% spike) · Chase Brown p95 35 (17.4% spike) · Tee Higgins p95 33 (18.8% spike)

3 players clear the alpha-ceiling bar, led by Ja'Marr Chase (p95 47, hits a spike week 16.0% of the time). This is the currency that wins best ball — these are the weekly outcomes that drag a lineup into the 90th percentile. Highest-variance (boom/bust) of the group: Ja'Marr Chase, Tee Higgins — exactly the volatility you want on a bench that only counts its best weeks.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: Ja'Marr Chase (99%), Chase Brown (85%), Tee Higgins (85%). Pure spike

profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): Mike Gesicki, Samaje Perine, Andrei Iosivas — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Joe Burrow + Ja'Marr Chase / Tee Higgins — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r \approx 0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is BAL@CIN — a top-tier blow-up game (tail rank #2); the natural bring-back is a BAL pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byes fall in Week 6, and the playoff run is W15 vs CAR, W16 vs IND.

Coachspeak & film

On Ja'Marr Chase: “Jamar Chase finished as the wide receiver four in points per game after being selected as the wide receiver 21 in underdog drafts” (@joshnorris). On Joe Burrow: “You need the 12-yard line for a first down, Burrow, circling back” (@sigmundbloom).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around Ja'Marr Chase (board #3, ADP 3.2), with Chase Brown, Tee Higgins as the correlated ceiling pieces. Let the market overpay for Samaje Perine, Tahj Brooks.

Risks & flags

structural: a pass-first, low-carry script makes the backfield a committee/touchdown-variance bet

Atlanta Falcons (ATL)

Bye W11 • Playoffs: W15 WAS • W16 TB • W17 ATL@NO (finals tail #11) • 2 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A pass-first, high-volume attack and a middle scoring offense (1.88 implied TD/g, 23rd). 2 alpha-ceiling players (p95≥33); best board asset is Bijan Robinson at #4.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
4	Bijan Robinson	RB	2.1	46	16.3%	98%	19.7% tgt
15	Drake London	WR	15.7	38	16.5%	95%	29.9% tgt
100	Kyle Pitts Sr.	TE	93.9	28	17.7%	87%	22.7% tgt
179	Brian Robinson Jr.	RB	170.0	16	21.0%	45%	19.7% tgt
197	Tua Tagovailoa	QB	195.9	15	16.1%	21%	1.4 car/g
198	Zachariah Branch	WR	199.7	11	21.9%	22%	rookie/NA
223	Michael Penix Jr.	QB	220.3			18%	2.3 car/g
293	Olamide Zaccheaus	WR	232.2	13	22.5%	32%	13.5% tgt
387	Jahan Dotson	WR	230.1	16	20.3%	42%	8.5% tgt

Volume & script

60.2 plays/g (5th) • 33.4 pass att (7th) • 55.4% pass rate (10th) • 238.4 pass yds (8th) • 26.8 carries (20th) • 120.7 rush yds (15th) • 1.88 TD/g (23rd)

A balanced script (55.4% pass) spreads opportunity without a strong structural lean either way, and the pace is real — 60.2 snaps/g (5th) manufactures extra possessions for everyone. Scoring sits mid-pack (1.88 TD/g, 23rd).

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

Drake London 29.9% tgt / aDOT 10.8 / max 41.8 • Kyle Pitts Sr. 22.7% tgt / aDOT 7.3 / max 48.6 • Olamide Zaccheaus 13.5% tgt / aDOT 7.3 / max 17.8 • Bijan Robinson 16.9 car/g, 4.6 rec/g, max 42.9

Drake London is the focal point — a 29.9% target share in 2025 (fairly stable, cv 0.38), at a 10.8-yard aDOT (all-levels routes), peaking at 41.8 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Kyle Pitts Sr. (22.7%). In the backfield Bijan Robinson profiled as a true workhorse (16.9 carries/g, and he caught 4.6 balls/g); ceiling week 42.9 DK. Small-sample caveat: Michael Penix Jr. (9g) missed time, so the rates ride a partial season.

2026 outlook: what changes

Volume shift: Clay projects 33.4 pass att/g in 2026 vs 33.8 actual in 2025 (-0.4) — holding steady on pass volume. Vacated opportunity: ~20.7% of the 2025 target volume turned over (meaningful turnover) — out: D.Mooney (13.8%, to NYG), D.Sills (6.9%, gone). In: Tua Tagovailoa (from MIA); Olamide Zaccheaus (from CHI); Jahan Dotson (from PHI) • rookies: Zachariah Branch. Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): Bijan Robinson 20.6/g proj vs 23.1/g in 2025 (-2.5, projected to regress); Drake London 15.9/g proj vs 18.0/g in 2025 (-2.1, projected to regress); Kyle Pitts Sr. 10.8/g proj vs 12.6/g in 2025 (-1.8, roughly steady); Brian Robinson Jr. 5.6/g proj vs 23.1/g in 2025 (-17.5, projected to regress).

Ceiling & upside

Bijan Robinson p95 46 (16.3% spike) • Drake London p95 38 (16.5% spike)

2 players clear the alpha-ceiling bar, led by Bijan Robinson (p95 46, hits a spike week 16.3% of the time). This is the currency that wins best ball — these are the weekly outcomes that drag a lineup into the 90th percentile.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: Bijan Robinson (98%), Drake London (95%), Kyle Pitts Sr. (87%). Pure spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): Brian Robinson Jr., Zachariah Branch, Olamide Zaccheaus — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Tua Tagovailoa + Drake London / Kyle Pitts Sr. — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r \approx 0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is ATL@NO — a mid-tier finals game (tail rank #11); the natural bring-back is a NO pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byes fall in Week 11, and the playoff run is W15 vs WAS, W16 vs TB.

Coachspeak & film

On the team: “And it goes to show how much he is such a huge part of the Falcons offense”. On Bijan Robinson: “Didn’t understand why Bijan Robinson opened as the 1.1 in ADP over Jahmyr Gibbs” (@adamlevitan). On Drake London: “Isn’t that the case for Drake London + Nico Collins as top-10 WRs and Round 2 picks despite the QB questions?” (@ihartitz). On Zachariah Branch: “Falcons third-round rookie receiver Zachariah Branch had a strong day fresh off his trip to Los Angeles for the NFLPA rookie premiere, which spanned May 14-16 and featured 42 draft picks” (@32beatwriters).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around Bijan Robinson (board #4, ADP 2.1), with Drake London as the correlated ceiling pieces. Let the market overpay for Olamide Zaccheaus, Jahan Dotson.

Risks & flags

No specific risk overlays on this group; the main risk is generic (price vs the field).

Seattle Seahawks (SEA)

Bye W11 • Playoffs: W15 PHI • W16 LAR • W17 CAR@SEA (finals tail #5) • 1 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A run-leaning, low-snap attack and a middle scoring offense (2.53 implied TD/g, 11th). 1 alpha-ceiling player (p95≥33); best board asset is Jaxon Smith-Njigba at #5.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
5	Jaxon Smith-Njigba	WR	5.4	47	15.8%	99%	rookie/NA
66	Jadarian Price	RB	60.2	28	18.6%	70%	rookie/NA
129	Sam Darnold	QB	135.6	31	15.8%	49%	2.0 car/g
142	Zach Charbonnet	RB	148.6	31	21.4%	73%	7.5% tgt
152	Rashid Shaheed	WR	146.2	23	19.4%	60%	15.5% tgt
180	AJ Barner	TE	182.0	19	20.1%	51%	14.1% tgt
195	Cooper Kupp	WR	194.9	18	20.7%	48%	17.9% tgt
207	Emanuel Wilson	RB	191.1	2	16.2%	7%	6.7% tgt
226	George Holani	RB	225.9	9	22.9%	26%	8.2% tgt

Volume & script

58.4 plays/g (24th) • 30.2 pass att (27th) • 51.7% pass rate (26th) • 236.0 pass yds (9th) • 28.2 carries (7th) • 114.3 rush yds (23rd) • 2.53 TD/g (11th)

A run-leaning script (51.7% pass vs 54% league) tilts value toward the backfield and compresses the passing pie, but the deliberate pace (58.4 snaps/g, 24th) caps the raw opportunity to go around. Scoring sits mid-pack (2.53 TD/g, 11th).

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

Cooper Kupp 17.9% tgt / aDOT 7.6 / max 16.0 • Rashid Shaheed 15.5% tgt / aDOT 12.9 / max 24.4 • AJ Barner 14.1% tgt / aDOT 4.5 / max 24.3 • Zach Charbonnet 11.2 car/g, 1.2 rec/g, max 29.2

Cooper Kupp is the focal point — a 17.9% target share in 2025 (fairly stable, cv 0.43), at a 7.6-yard aDOT (short-area routes), peaking at 16.0 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Rashid Shaheed (15.5%). In the backfield Zach Charbonnet profiled as the lead of a rotation (11.2 carries/g, with a thin receiving role); ceiling week 29.2 DK. Small-sample caveat: Tory Horton (7g) missed time, so the rates ride a partial season.

2026 outlook: what changes

Volume shift: Clay projects 30.2 pass att/g in 2026 vs 30.4 actual in 2025 (-0.2) — holding steady on pass volume. Vacated opportunity: ~38.7% of the 2025 target volume turned over (major turnover) — out: J.Smith-Njigba (31.0%, gone), K.Walker (7.7%, to KC). In: Emanuel Wilson (from GB) • rookies: Jaxon Smith-Njigba, Jadarian Price. Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): Sam Darnold 15.5/g proj vs 15.3/g in 2025 (+0.2, roughly steady); Zach Charbonnet 12.0/g proj vs 10.8/g in 2025 (+1.2, roughly steady); Rashid Shaheed 8.3/g proj vs 7.7/g in 2025 (+0.6, roughly steady); AJ Barner 6.7/g proj vs 8.3/g in 2025 (-1.6, roughly steady).

Ceiling & upside

Jaxon Smith-Njigba p95 47 (15.8% spike)

1 players clear the alpha-ceiling bar, led by Jaxon Smith-Njigba (p95 47, hits a spike week 15.8% of the time). This is the currency that wins best ball — these are the weekly outcomes that drag a lineup into the 90th percentile.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: Jaxon Smith-Njigba (99%), Zach Charbonnet (73%), Jadarian Price (70%). Pure spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): Jadarian Price, Zach Charbonnet, Rashid Shaheed — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Sam Darnold + Jaxon Smith-Njigba / Rashid Shaheed — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r \approx 0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is CAR@SEA — a top-tier blow-up game (tail rank #5); the natural bring-back is a CAR pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byes fall in Week 11, and the playoff run is W15 vs PHI, W16 vs LAR.

Coachspeak & film

On the team: “They signed Connor Hayward in free agency, and all of that is to present as if they are running the football, but if you go and you look at Clint's offense last year in Seattle, 23rd in rushing success rate, 20th in explosive rush rate”. On Jadarian Price: “Also, first round pick Jadarian Price is going to have a very long runway to try and prove to the coaching staff that he should be RB1” (@coachspeakindex). On Sam Darnold: “He's going to have a full off season now to build chemistry with Sam Darnold as well” (@jamesdkoh). On AJ Barner: “Franken signing these late round tight ends, he is someone that I really am attacking because I think it's kind of fitting that he's staying next to AJ Barner in drafts” (@joshnorris).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around Jaxon Smith-Njigba (board #5, ADP 5.4). Let the market overpay for Emanuel Wilson, Tory Horton.

Risks & flags

Cooper Kupp — age: Age / role-decline flag. 11

San Francisco 49ers (SF)

Bye W8 · Playoffs: W15 LAC · W16 KC · W17 PHI@SF (finals tail #8) · 3 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A balanced, average-pace attack and a middle scoring offense (2.59 implied TD/g, 9th). 3 alpha-ceiling players (p95≥33); best board asset is Christian McCaffrey at #6.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
6	Christian McCaffrey	RB	6.3	44	15.8%	99%	23.3% tgt
52	Mike Evans	WR	52.0	30	18.8%	74%	rookie/NA
93	Brock Purdy	QB	98.8	36	14.9%	82%	4.3 car/g
104	George Kittle	TE	104.9	33	18.7%	96%	20.1% tgt
114	Ricky Pearsall	WR	107.4	27	18.6%	64%	16.8% tgt
181	De'Zhaun Stribling	WR	176.9	13	24.2%	30%	rookie/NA
200	Brandon Aiyuk	WR	204.3				rookie/NA
216	Christian Kirk	WR	208.6	13	24.3%	35%	15.7% tgt
227	Kaelon Black	RB	217.6	7	20.5%	17%	rookie/NA

Volume & script

59.2 plays/g (14th) · 31.2 pass att (20th) · 52.7% pass rate (23rd) · 245.9 pass yds (5th) · 28.0 carries (9th) · 117.2 rush yds (19th) · 2.59 TD/g (9th)

A balanced script (52.7% pass) spreads opportunity without a strong structural lean either way. Scoring sits mid-pack (2.59 TD/g, 9th).

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

George Kittle 20.1% tgt / aDOT 6.7 / max 27.5 · Ricky Pearsall 16.8% tgt / aDOT 13.8 / max 22.7 · Christian Kirk 15.7% tgt / aDOT 7.4 / max 31.4 · Christian McCaffrey 17.7 car/g, 5.9 rec/g, max 42.1

George Kittle is the focal point — a 20.1% target share in 2025 (fairly stable, cv 0.41), at a 6.7-yard aDOT (short-area routes), peaking at 27.5 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Ricky Pearsall (16.8%), Christian Kirk (15.7%). In the backfield Christian McCaffrey profiled as a true workhorse (17.7 carries/g, and he caught 5.9 balls/g); ceiling week 42.1 DK.

2026 outlook: what changes

Volume shift: Clay projects 31.2 pass att/g in 2026 vs 35.4 actual in 2025 (-4.2) — projected for lower pass volume / more run than 2025. Vacated opportunity: ~38.6% of the 2025 target volume turned over (major turnover) — out: J.Jennings (16.7%, to MIN), K.Bourne (9.1%, to ARI), D.Robinson (7.3%, gone), K.Juszczyk (5.5%, gone). In: Christian Kirk (from HOU) · rookies: Mike Evans, De'Zhaun Stribling, Brandon Aiyuk. Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): Christian McCaffrey 20.8/g proj vs 24.7/g in 2025 (-3.9, projected to regress); Brock Purdy 18.4/g proj vs 19.8/g in 2025 (-1.4, roughly steady); George Kittle 12.7/g proj vs 13.8/g in 2025 (-1.1, roughly steady); Ricky Pearsall 9.8/g proj vs 9.5/g in 2025 (+0.3, roughly steady).

Ceiling & upside

Christian McCaffrey p95 44 (15.8% spike) · Brock Purdy p95 36 (14.9% spike) · George Kittle p95 33 (18.7% spike)

3 players clear the alpha-ceiling bar, led by Christian McCaffrey (p95 44, hits a spike week 15.8% of the time). This is the currency that wins best ball — these are the weekly outcomes that drag a lineup into the 90th percentile. Highest-variance (boom/bust) of the group: George Kittle — exactly the volatility you want on a bench that only counts its best weeks.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: Christian McCaffrey (99%), George Kittle (96%), Brock Purdy (82%).

Pure spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): Mike Evans, Ricky Pearsall, De'Zhaun Stribling — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Brock Purdy + George Kittle / Mike Evans — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r \approx 0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is PHI@SF — a mid-tier finals game (tail rank #8); the natural bring-back is a PHI pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byes fall in Week 8, and the playoff run is W15 vs LAC, W16 vs KC.

Coachspeak & film

On the team: “And then maybe Brandon Ayuk like on August 1st, if he wants to show up and the 49ers want to release him from being a hostage”. On Mike Evans: “Before injuries hit in 2025, Evans averaged 11.3 PPR points at 47 yards per game” (@supernova38). On George Kittle: “With Kittle, I think I have some downside risk” (@fantasypts). On Brandon Aiyuk: “You draft no Wide Receivers in best ball and then finish the draft with: Stefon Diggs Travis Hunter Brandon Aiyuk Tank Dell Deebo Samuel Tyreek Hill And 2 other guys” (@chessliam).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around Christian McCaffrey (board #6, ADP 6.3), with Brock Purdy, George Kittle as the correlated ceiling pieces. Let the market overpay for Jordan James, Jake Tonges.

Risks & flags

Mike Evans — age: Age / role-decline flag. 11 • George Kittle — injury: Achilles; 61.9% inline negative indicator verify camp. 11

Indianapolis Colts (IND)

Bye W13 · Playoffs: W15 TEN · W16 CIN · W17 CLE@IND (finals tail #15) · 1 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A balanced, low-snap attack and a middle scoring offense (2.29 implied TD/g, 17th). 1 alpha-ceiling player (p95≥33); best board asset is Jonathan Taylor at #8.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
8	Jonathan Taylor	RB	7.7	40	16.1%	97%	11.8% tgt
67	Tyler Warren	TE	61.9	30	17.8%	92%	21.6% tgt
80	Alec Pierce	WR	72.7	31	18.4%	79%	17.4% tgt
108	Josh Downs	WR	104.8	26	18.8%	66%	17.3% tgt
137	Daniel Jones	QB	142.8	28	8.9%	62%	3.5 car/g
266	Nick Westbrook-Ikhine	WR	232.0	17	20.9%	46%	rookie/NA
277	Deion Burks	WR	230.6				rookie/NA
331	DJ Giddens	RB	228.8	7	22.0%	21%	3.0% tgt
374	Anthony Richardson Sr.	QB	230.9				2.9% tgt

Volume & script

58.0 plays/g (31st) · 31.0 pass att (23rd) · 53.4% pass rate (20th) · 220.2 pass yds (28th) · 27.0 carries (18th) · 121.2 rush yds (14th) · 2.29 TD/g (17th)

A balanced script (53.4% pass) spreads opportunity without a strong structural lean either way, but the deliberate pace (58.0 snaps/g, 31st) caps the raw opportunity to go around. Scoring sits mid-pack (2.29 TD/g, 17th).

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

Tyler Warren 21.6% tgt / aDOT 5.3 / max 18.3 · Alec Pierce 17.4% tgt / aDOT 19.0 / max 32.2 · Josh Downs 17.3% tgt / aDOT 7.5 / max 17.0 · Jonathan Taylor 19.1 car/g, 2.7 rec/g, max 52.6

Tyler Warren is the focal point — a 21.6% target share in 2025 (rock-steady, cv 0.29), at a 5.3-yard aDOT (short-area routes), peaking at 18.3 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Alec Pierce (17.4%), Josh Downs (17.3%). In the backfield Jonathan Taylor profiled as a true workhorse (19.1 carries/g, with a thin receiving role); ceiling week 52.6 DK. Small-sample caveat: Anthony Richardson Sr. (2g), Riley Leonard (5g) missed time, so the rates ride a partial season.

2026 outlook: what changes

Volume shift: Clay projects 31.0 pass att/g in 2026 vs 34.2 actual in 2025 (-3.2) — projected for lower pass volume / more run than 2025. Vacated opportunity: ~41.1% of the 2025 target volume turned over (major turnover) — out: M.Pittman (19.2%, to PIT), A.Mitchell (12.5%, to NYJ), J.Taylor (9.4%, to JAX). Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): Jonathan Taylor 18.3/g proj vs 22.1/g in 2025 (-3.8, projected to regress); Tyler Warren 12.1/g proj vs 11.1/g in 2025 (+1.0, roughly steady); Alec Pierce 11.8/g proj vs 12.6/g in 2025 (-0.8, roughly steady); Josh Downs 9.8/g proj vs 8.5/g in 2025 (+1.3, roughly steady).

Ceiling & upside

Jonathan Taylor p95 40 (16.1% spike)

1 players clear the alpha-ceiling bar, led by Jonathan Taylor (p95 40, hits a spike week 16.1% of the time). This is the currency that wins best ball — these are the weekly outcomes that drag a lineup into the 90th percentile.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: Jonathan Taylor (97%), Tyler Warren (92%), Alec Pierce (79%). Pure spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): Alec Pierce, Josh Downs, Nick Westbrook-Ikhine — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Daniel Jones + Alec Pierce / Tyler Warren — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r \approx 0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is CLE@IND — a lower-variance finals game (tail rank #15); the natural bring-back is a CLE pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byes fall in Week 13, and the playoff run is W15 vs TEN, W16 vs CIN.

Coachspeak & film

On Alec Pierce: “Alec Pierce being the WR34 in ADP seems very off” (@haydenwinks). On Josh Downs: “I would not be shocked whatsoever if Josh Downs led the Colts in receptions this year” (@jamesdkoh). On DJ Giddens: “It has been Giddens getting the initial first-team reps, although they've both rotated” (@dhananizain). On Seth McGowan: “Now, McGowan is a guy I am a little more confident” (@dhananizain).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around Jonathan Taylor (board #8, ADP 7.7). Let the market overpay for Nick Westbrook-Ikhine, Deion Burks.

Risks & flags

No specific risk overlays on this group; the main risk is generic (price vs the field).

Dallas Cowboys (DAL)

Bye W14 • Playoffs: W15 LAR • W16 JAX • W17 DAL@NYG (finals tail #3) • 4 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A balanced, high-volume attack and a top scoring offense (2.76 implied TD/g, 5th). 4 alpha-ceiling players (p95≥33); best board asset is CeeDee Lamb at #9.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
9	CeeDee Lamb	WR	10.8	42	16.8%	97%	25.0% tgt
28	George Pickens	WR	24.2	36	16.8%	90%	22.6% tgt
35	Javonte Williams	RB	37.8	35	17.5%	84%	9.1% tgt
71	Dak Prescott	QB	76.4	35	15.2%	72%	3.1 car/g
128	Jake Ferguson	TE	127.6	25	19.8%	79%	16.5% tgt
176	Ryan Flurnoy	WR	172.9	17	21.5%	45%	12.7% tgt
228	Jaydon Blue	RB	224.3	7	20.5%	19%	3.3% tgt
260	Michael Trigg	TE	229.2				rookie/NA
278	Malik Davis	RB	228.9	9	23.9%	29%	7.1% tgt

Volume & script

61.5 plays/g (1st) • 34.1 pass att (3rd) • 55.4% pass rate (11th) • 251.2 pass yds (3rd) • 27.5 carries (14th) • 119.3 rush yds (17th) • 2.76 TD/g (5th)

A balanced script (55.4% pass) spreads opportunity without a strong structural lean either way, and the pace is real — 61.5 snaps/g (1st) manufactures extra possessions for everyone. Most important for best ball: 2.76 implied TD/g (5th) is a top-tier scoring environment that raises every weekly ceiling.

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

CeeDee Lamb 25.0% tgt / aDOT 12.0 / max 27.2 • George Pickens 22.6% tgt / aDOT 11.2 / max 36.4 • Jake Ferguson 16.5% tgt / aDOT 4.6 / max 23.9 • Javonte Williams 15.8 car/g, 2.2 rec/g, max 29.9

CeeDee Lamb is the focal point — a 25.0% target share in 2025 (fairly stable, cv 0.34), at a 12.0-yard aDOT (downfield routes), peaking at 27.2 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to George Pickens (22.6%), Jake Ferguson (16.5%). In the backfield Javonte Williams profiled as a true workhorse (15.8 carries/g, with a thin receiving role); ceiling week 29.9 DK. Small-sample caveat: Joe Milton III (4g) missed time, so the rates ride a partial season.

2026 outlook: what changes

Volume shift: Clay projects 34.1 pass att/g in 2026 vs 38.7 actual in 2025 (-4.6) — projected for lower pass volume / more run than 2025. Vacated opportunity: ~5.7% of the 2025 target volume turned over (a largely intact target tree) — out: J.Tolbert (5.7%, to MIA). Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): CeeDee Lamb 17.5/g proj vs 16.8/g in 2025 (+0.7, roughly steady); George Pickens 14.1/g proj vs 17.9/g in 2025 (-3.8, projected to regress); Javonte Williams 15.4/g proj vs 15.7/g in 2025 (-0.3, roughly steady); Dak Prescott 17.8/g proj vs 19.7/g in 2025 (-1.9, roughly steady).

Ceiling & upside

CeeDee Lamb p95 42 (16.8% spike) • George Pickens p95 36 (16.8% spike) • Javonte Williams p95 35 (17.5% spike) • Dak Prescott p95 35 (15.2% spike)

4 players clear the alpha-ceiling bar, led by CeeDee Lamb (p95 42, hits a spike week 16.8% of the time). This is the currency that wins best ball — these are the weekly outcomes that drag a lineup into the 90th percentile. Highest-variance (boom/bust) of the group: George Pickens — exactly the volatility you want on a bench that only counts its best weeks.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: CeeDee Lamb (97%), George Pickens (90%), Javonte Williams (84%).

Pure spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): Jake Ferguson, Ryan Flurnoy, Jaydon Blue — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Dak Prescott + CeeDee Lamb / George Pickens — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r \approx 0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is DAL@NYG — a top-tier blow-up game (tail rank #3); the natural bring-back is a NYG pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byes fall in Week 14, and the playoff run is W15 vs LAR, W16 vs JAX.

Coachspeak & film

On CeeDee Lamb: “Last year, CeeDee Lamb and George Pickens combined for the 2nd-most receiving yards out of any WR1/WR2 duo in the league (2,508) But who is a better draft pick at cost in 2026?” (@fantasypts). On George Pickens: “Last year, CeeDee Lamb and George Pickens combined for the 2nd-most receiving yards out of any WR1/WR2 duo in the league (2,508) But who is a better draft pick at cost in 2026?” (@fantasypts).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around CeeDee Lamb (board #9, ADP 10.8), with George Pickens, Javonte Williams as the correlated ceiling pieces. Let the market overpay for Michael Trigg, Malik Davis.

Risks & flags

No specific risk overlays on this group; the main risk is generic (price vs the field).

Minnesota Vikings (MIN)

Bye W6 • Playoffs: W15 DET • W16 WAS • W17 MIN@NYJ (finals tail #7) • 1 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A pass-first, high-volume attack and a middle scoring offense (2.12 implied TD/g, 21st). 1 alpha-ceiling player (p95≥33); best board asset is Justin Jefferson at #10.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
10	Justin Jefferson	WR	8.8	41	16.2%	96%	30.5% tgt
102	Jordan Addison	WR	96.3	27	18.9%	68%	18.1% tgt
106	Kyler Murray	QB	108.4	25	8.6%	46%	5.8 car/g
119	Aaron Jones Sr.	RB	119.4	27	17.9%	67%	14.0% tgt
134	Jordan Mason	RB	130.1	19	20.2%	51%	6.2% tgt
157	Jauan Jennings	WR	150.6	19	20.4%	53%	19.6% tgt
159	T.J. Hockenson	TE	162.5	24	19.0%	73%	15.8% tgt
231	Demond Claiborne	RB	224.3	6	20.1%	9%	rookie/NA
241	J.J. McCarthy	QB	225.6			10%	3.7 car/g

Volume & script

60.1 plays/g (6th) • 33.9 pass att (4th) • 56.4% pass rate (4th) • 232.0 pass yds (13th) • 26.2 carries (26th) • 124.6 rush yds (11th) • 2.12 TD/g (21st)

This is a genuinely pass-first script — 56.4% pass rate against a 54% league mean — so the receiving corps, not the backfield, is where the fantasy points concentrate, and the pace is real — 60.1 snaps/g (6th) manufactures extra possessions for everyone. Scoring sits mid-pack (2.12 TD/g, 21st).

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

Justin Jefferson 30.5% tgt / aDOT 10.1 / max 25.6 • Jauan Jennings 19.6% tgt / aDOT 10.0 / max 19.9 • Jordan Addison 18.1% tgt / aDOT 13.7 / max 24.8 • Aaron Jones Sr. 11.0 car/g, 2.3 rec/g, max 15.9

Justin Jefferson is the focal point — a 30.5% target share in 2025 (rock-steady, cv 0.19), at a 10.1-yard aDOT (all-levels routes), peaking at 25.6 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Jauan Jennings (19.6%), Jordan Addison (18.1%). In the backfield Aaron Jones Sr. profiled as the lead of a rotation (11.0 carries/g, with a thin receiving role); ceiling week 15.9 DK. Small-sample caveat: Kyler Murray (5g) missed time, so the rates ride a partial season.

2026 outlook: what changes

Volume shift: Clay projects 33.9 pass att/g in 2026 vs 32.2 actual in 2025 (+1.7) — leaning more pass-heavy than 2025. Vacated opportunity: ~22.8% of the 2025 target volume turned over (meaningful turnover) — out: J.Nailor (11.0%, to LV), A.Thielen (7.7%, gone), J.Oliver (4.1%, gone). In: Kyler Murray (from ARI); Jauan Jennings (from SF). Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): Justin Jefferson 17.2/g proj vs 12.4/g in 2025 (+4.8, trending up); Jordan Addison 9.9/g proj vs 10.0/g in 2025 (-0.1, roughly steady); Kyler Murray 15.4/g proj vs 16.2/g in 2025 (-0.8, roughly steady, joins from ARI); Aaron Jones Sr. 11.3/g proj vs 10.0/g in 2025 (+1.3, roughly steady).

Ceiling & upside

Justin Jefferson p95 41 (16.2% spike)

1 players clear the alpha-ceiling bar, led by Justin Jefferson (p95 41, hits a spike week 16.2% of the time). This is the currency that wins best ball — these are the weekly outcomes that drag a lineup into the 90th percentile.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: Justin Jefferson (96%), T.J. Hockenson (73%), Jordan Addison (68%). Pure spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): Jordan Addison, Jordan Mason, Jauan Jennings — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Kyler Murray + Justin Jefferson / Jordan Addison — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r \approx 0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is MIN@NYJ — a mid-tier finals game (tail rank #7); the natural bring-back is a NYJ pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byes fall in Week 6, and the playoff run is W15 vs DET, W16 vs WAS.

Coachspeak & film

On Kyler Murray: “-Kyler Murray might be THE late-round QB -Aaron Jones goes Round 11!” (@ihartitz). On Aaron Jones Sr.: “I think MIN would be a dream landing spot with Aaron Jones taking a pay cut, Jordan Mason on final year of contract and hasn't shown much as a Viking and only drafting a 6th rd Demond Claiborne” (@smitchell17). On Jordan Mason: “I think MIN would be a dream landing spot with Aaron Jones taking a pay cut, Jordan Mason on final year of contract and hasn't shown much as a Viking and only drafting a 6th rd Demond Claiborne” (@smitchell17). On Demond Claiborne: “I think MIN would be a dream landing spot with Aaron Jones taking a pay cut, Jordan Mason on final year of contract and hasn't shown much as a Viking and only drafting a 6th rd Demond Claiborne” (@smitchell17).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around Justin Jefferson (board #10, ADP 8.8). Let the market overpay for J.J. McCarthy.

Risks & flags

structural: a pass-first, low-carry script makes the backfield a committee/touchdown-variance bet

Kansas City Chiefs (KC)

Bye W5 • Playoffs: W15 NE • W16 SF • W17 KC@LAC (finals tail #9) • 2 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A pass-first, high-volume attack and a middle scoring offense (2.59 implied TD/g, 9th). 2 alpha-ceiling players (p95≥33); best board asset is Kenneth Walker III at #11.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
11	Kenneth Walker III	RB	15.3				9.5% tgt
24	Rashee Rice	WR	31.2	38	16.3%	96%	29.1% tgt
88	Patrick Mahomes	QB	93.3	34	14.3%	69%	3.4% tgt
117	Xavier Worthy	WR	112.3	28	18.5%	71%	16.0% tgt
122	Travis Kelce	TE	116.8	27	18.1%	83%	20.1% tgt
199	Emmett Johnson	RB	193.2	9	24.2%	28%	rookie/NA
243	Tyquan Thornton	WR	226.0	15	22.3%	40%	9.8% tgt
249	Jaydn Ott	RB	226.5				rookie/NA
257	Brashard Smith	RB	226.8			1%	9.3% tgt

Volume & script

60.4 plays/g (2nd) • 33.6 pass att (5th) • 55.7% pass rate (9th) • 243.1 pass yds (6th) • 26.8 carries (21st) • 126.6 rush yds (8th) • 2.59 TD/g (9th)

A balanced script (55.7% pass) spreads opportunity without a strong structural lean either way, and the pace is real — 60.4 snaps/g (2nd) manufactures extra possessions for everyone. Scoring sits mid-pack (2.59 TD/g, 9th).

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

Rashee Rice 29.1% tgt / aDOT 4.3 / max 29.4 • Travis Kelce 20.1% tgt / aDOT 6.7 / max 24.1 • Xavier Worthy 16.0% tgt / aDOT 12.9 / max 17.1 • Kenneth Walker III 14.3 car/g, 2.0 rec/g, max 38.5

Rashee Rice is the focal point — a 29.1% target share in 2025 (rock-steady, cv 0.2), at a 4.3-yard aDOT (short-area routes), peaking at 29.4 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Travis Kelce (20.1%), Xavier Worthy (16.0%). In the backfield Kenneth Walker III (2025 with SEA) profiled as the lead of a rotation (14.3 carries/g, with a thin receiving role); ceiling week 38.5 DK. Small-sample caveat: Rashee Rice (8g), Justin Fields (9g) missed time, so the rates ride a partial season.

2026 outlook: what changes

Volume shift: Clay projects 33.6 pass att/g in 2026 vs 37.3 actual in 2025 (-3.7) — projected for lower pass volume / more run than 2025. Vacated opportunity: ~30.8% of the 2025 target volume turned over (meaningful turnover) — out: M.Brown (13.4%, gone), J.Smith-Schuster (8.2%, gone), I.Pacheco (4.7%, to DET), K.Hunt (4.5%, to FA). In: Kenneth Walker III (from SEA); Justin Fields (from NYJ) • rookies: Emmett Johnson. Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): Rashee Rice 16.1/g proj vs 18.9/g in 2025 (-2.8, projected to regress); Patrick Mahomes 17.8/g proj vs 21.3/g in 2025 (-3.5, projected to regress); Xavier Worthy 10.4/g proj vs 7.9/g in 2025 (+2.5, trending up); Travis Kelce 10.3/g proj vs 11.2/g in 2025 (-0.9, roughly steady).

Ceiling & upside

Rashee Rice p95 38 (16.3% spike) • Patrick Mahomes p95 34 (14.3% spike)

2 players clear the alpha-ceiling bar, led by Rashee Rice (p95 38, hits a spike week 16.3% of the time). This is the currency that wins best ball — these are the weekly outcomes that drag a lineup into the 90th percentile. Highest-variance (boom/bust) of the group: Rashee Rice — exactly the volatility you want on a bench that only counts its best weeks.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: Rashee Rice (96%), Travis Kelce (83%), Xavier Worthy (71%). Pure spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): Xavier Worthy, Emmett Johnson, Tyquan Thornton — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Patrick Mahomes + Rashee Rice / Xavier Worthy — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r \approx 0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is KC@LAC — a mid-tier finals game (tail rank #9); the natural bring-back is a LAC pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byes fall in Week 5, and the playoff run is W15 vs NE, W16 vs SF.

Coachspeak & film

On the team: “The AFC West may not have seen an elite speed number one receiver like Jalen Waddell since Tyreek Hill with the Chiefs, and he gives defenses something else to think about”. On Kenneth Walker III: “Kenneth Walker is an aggressive runner, but it's actually been his agility and acceleration that have really shown up in the playoffs” (@syedschemes). On Rashee Rice: “If you anticipate Rashee Rice either A.) fucks up again or B.) gets suspended and misses a chunk of the season Why are you not taking Jalen Royals in EVERY draft?” (@smitchell17). On Patrick Mahomes: “And some men have Patrick Mahomes past ADP” (@patkerrane).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around Rashee Rice (board #24, ADP 31.2), with Patrick Mahomes as the correlated ceiling pieces. Let the market overpay for Tyquan Thornton, Jaydn Ott.

Risks & flags

Rashee Rice — risk: Serving jail time (street-racing plea); bearish-gated. Discount-only talent bet. 11

Miami Dolphins (MIA)

Bye W6 • Playoffs: W15 GB • W16 LAC • W17 BUF@MIA (finals tail #16) • 1 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A run-leaning, low-snap attack and a muted scoring offense (1.35 implied TD/g, 32nd). 1 alpha-ceiling player (p95≥33); best board asset is De'Von Achane at #12.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
12	De'Von Achane	RB	16.9	40	16.5%	95%	18.6% tgt
125	Malik Willis	QB	129.1	28	13.0%	38%	rookie/NA
173	Malik Washington	WR	170.8	18	20.2%	49%	14.4% tgt
184	Greg Dulcich	TE	192.4	19	19.5%	51%	15.8% tgt
203	Chris Bell	WR	205.9	19	19.6%	50%	rookie/NA
272	Jalen Tolbert	WR	228.2	13	22.2%	34%	8.5% tgt
273	Ollie Gordon II	RB	226.9	6	21.5%	16%	3.9% tgt
284	Tutu Atwell	WR	227.8	11	20.0%	20%	4.9% tgt
294	Jaylen Wright	RB	229.7	8	21.8%	24%	7.4% tgt

Volume & script

58.2 plays/g (26th) • 29.7 pass att (29th) • 51.1% pass rate (28th) • 209.1 pass yds (32nd) • 28.5 carries (6th) • 140.1 rush yds (3rd) • 1.35 TD/g (32nd)

A run-leaning script (51.1% pass vs 54% league) tilts value toward the backfield and compresses the passing pie, but the deliberate pace (58.2 snaps/g, 26th) caps the raw opportunity to go around. The 32nd-ranked scoring rate (1.35 TD/g) is the cap here — touchdown-dependent ceilings get harder to hit.

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

Greg Dulcich 15.8% tgt / aDOT 4.6 / max 16.1 • Kevin Coleman Jr. 15.3% tgt / aDOT 11.0 / max 28.2 • Malik Washington 14.4% tgt / aDOT 5.2 / max 13.6 • De'Von Achane 14.9 car/g, 4.2 rec/g, max 43.5

Greg Dulcich is the focal point — a 15.8% target share in 2025 (fairly stable, cv 0.36), at a 4.6-yard aDOT (short-area routes), peaking at 16.1 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Kevin Coleman Jr. (15.3%). In the backfield De'Von Achane profiled as the lead of a rotation (14.9 carries/g, and he caught 4.2 balls/g); ceiling week 43.5 DK. Small-sample caveat: Greg Dulcich (9g), Tutu Atwell (8g) missed time, so the rates ride a partial season.

2026 outlook: what changes

Scheme watch — “When new general manager John Eric Sullivan and new head coach Jeff Halfley arrived in Miami earlier this year, we saw one of the biggest overhauls of a roster that we have ever seen in the NFL” (@coachspeakindex). Volume shift: Clay projects 29.7 pass att/g in 2026 vs 30.6 actual in 2025 (-0.9) — holding steady on pass volume. Vacated opportunity: ~44.0% of the 2025 target volume turned over (major turnover) — out: J.Waddle (21.5%, to DEN), D.Waller (7.5%, to FA), T.Hill (6.2%, gone), J.Hill (4.5%, gone). In: Jalen Tolbert (from DAL); Tutu Atwell (from LAR); Kevin Coleman Jr. (from BUF) • rookies: Malik Willis. Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): De'Von Achane 17.6/g proj vs 20.9/g in 2025 (-3.3, projected to regress); Malik Washington 6.1/g proj vs 6.6/g in 2025 (-0.5, roughly steady); Greg Dulcich 6.7/g proj vs 7.1/g in 2025 (-0.4, roughly steady); Jalen Tolbert 3.9/g proj vs 4.0/g in 2025 (-0.1, roughly steady, joins from DAL).

Ceiling & upside

De'Von Achane p95 40 (16.5% spike)

1 players clear the alpha-ceiling bar, led by De'Von Achane (p95 40, hits a spike week 16.5% of the time). This is the currency that wins best ball — these are the weekly outcomes that drag a lineup into the 90th percentile.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: De'Von Achane (95%), Greg Dulcich (51%), Chris Bell (50%). Pure spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): Malik Washington, Greg Dulcich, Chris Bell — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Malik Willis + Greg Dulcich / Chris Bell — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r \approx 0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is BUF@MIA — a lower-variance finals game (tail rank #16); the natural bring-back is a BUF pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byes fall in Week 6, and the playoff run is W15 vs GB, W16 vs LAC.

Coachspeak & film

On the team: “When new general manager John Eric Sullivan and new head coach Jeff Halfley arrived in Miami earlier this year, we saw one of the biggest overhauls of a roster that we have ever seen in the NFL”. On De'Von Achane: “He should be watching as much Devon Achan tape as possible because that's like what he should look like” (@joshnorris). On Malik Willis: “I almost want to put like Malik Willis in his own tier because he's a different type of quarterback than all these next ones” (@haydenwinks). On Greg Dulcich: “Among tight ends who ran at least 25 routes in 2025, Dulcich ranked 5th in targets per route run, 2nd in yards per route run, and 7th in yards after the catch per reception” (@coachspeakindex).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around De'Von Achane (board #12, ADP 16.9). Board-vs-market values to exploit: Greg Dulcich (#184 vs ADP 192.4). Let the market overpay for Jalen Tolbert, Ollie Gordon II.

Risks & flags

No specific risk overlays on this group; the main risk is generic (price vs the field).

Buffalo Bills (BUF)

Bye W7 • Playoffs: W15 CHI • W16 DEN • W17 BUF@MIA (finals tail #16) • 2 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A run-leaning, high-volume attack and a top scoring offense (3.06 implied TD/g, 2nd). 2 alpha-ceiling players (p95≥33); best board asset is James Cook III at #13.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
13	James Cook III	RB	10.6	37	16.3%	94%	9.6% tgt
19	Josh Allen	QB	26.1	42	13.5%	100%	7.5 car/g
48	DJ Moore	WR	44.2	31	18.4%	81%	rookie/NA
120	Dalton Kincaid	TE	113.0	25	20.0%	69%	14.9% tgt
126	Khalil Shakir	WR	122.9	27	19.2%	68%	22.1% tgt
208	Ray Davis	RB	204.7	7	22.7%	20%	5.6% tgt
222	Keon Coleman	WR	214.4	12	24.3%	24%	15.3% tgt
269	Ty Johnson	RB	227.2	14	21.6%	41%	8.8% tgt
275	Joshua Palmer	WR	227.8				10.0% tgt

Volume & script

59.8 plays/g (8th) • 29.9 pass att (28th) • 50.0% pass rate (30th) • 232.1 pass yds (12th) • 29.9 carries (2nd) • 140.2 rush yds (2nd) • 3.06 TD/g (2nd)

A run-leaning script (50.0% pass vs 54% league) tilts value toward the backfield and compresses the passing pie, and the pace is real — 59.8 snaps/g (8th) manufactures extra possessions for everyone. Most important for best ball: 3.06 implied TD/g (2nd) is a top-tier scoring environment that raises every weekly ceiling.

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

Khalil Shakir 22.1% tgt / aDOT 3.3 / max 20.8 • Keon Coleman 15.3% tgt / aDOT 11.0 / max 28.2 • Dalton Kincaid 14.9% tgt / aDOT 9.2 / max 25.1 • James Cook III 18.3 car/g, 1.9 rec/g, max 36.6

Khalil Shakir is the focal point — a 22.1% target share in 2025 (fairly stable, cv 0.36), at a 3.3-yard aDOT (short-area routes), peaking at 20.8 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Keon Coleman (15.3%). In the backfield James Cook III profiled as a true workhorse (18.3 carries/g, with a thin receiving role); ceiling week 36.6 DK.

2026 outlook: what changes

Volume shift: Clay projects 29.9 pass att/g in 2026 vs 32.7 actual in 2025 (-2.8) — projected for lower pass volume / more run than 2025. Vacated opportunity: ~16.8% of the 2025 target volume turned over (a largely intact target tree) — out: K.Coleman (12.2%, to MIA), T.Shavers (4.6%, gone). In: no veteran additions of note • rookies: DJ Moore. Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): James Cook III 16.7/g proj vs 18.8/g in 2025 (-2.1, projected to regress); Josh Allen 22.3/g proj vs 24.4/g in 2025 (-2.1, projected to regress); Dalton Kincaid 9.0/g proj vs 11.7/g in 2025 (-2.7, projected to regress); Khalil Shakir 10.1/g proj vs 11.0/g in 2025 (-0.9, roughly steady).

Ceiling & upside

Josh Allen p95 42 (13.5% spike) • James Cook III p95 37 (16.3% spike)

2 players clear the alpha-ceiling bar, led by Josh Allen (p95 42, hits a spike week 13.5% of the time). This is the currency that wins best ball — these are the weekly outcomes that drag a lineup into the 90th percentile.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: Josh Allen (100%), James Cook III (94%), DJ Moore (81%). Pure spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): Dalton Kincaid, Khalil Shakir, Ray Davis — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Josh Allen + DJ Moore / Khalil Shakir — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r \approx 0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is BUF@MIA — a lower-variance finals game (tail rank #16); the natural bring-back is a MIA pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byes fall in Week 7, and the playoff run is W15 vs CHI, W16 vs DEN.

CoachSpeak & film

On DJ Moore: “Day one, I thought he was the future replacement for DJ Moore” (@joshnorris).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around James Cook III (board #13, ADP 10.6), with Josh Allen as the correlated ceiling pieces. Let the market overpay for Ty Johnson, Joshua Palmer.

Risks & flags

Dalton Kincaid — trap: Trap take Kyler Murray instead (+17). 4.2

Las Vegas Raiders (LV)

Bye W13 · Playoffs: W15 DEN · W16 TEN · W17 ARI@LV (finals tail #14) · 2 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A pass-first, high-volume attack and a muted scoring offense (1.71 implied TD/g, 28th). 2 alpha-ceiling players (p95≥33); best board asset is Ashton Jeanty at #14.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
14	Ashton Jeanty	RB	12.0	37	16.6%	92%	15.7% tgt
25	Brock Bowers	TE	19.5	34	17.5%	98%	23.5% tgt
156	Tre Tucker	WR	162.0	23	18.9%	58%	18.9% tgt
161	Jalen Nailor	WR	155.6	20	19.5%	55%	11.7% tgt
167	Fernando Mendoza	QB	165.6	23	14.9%	26%	rookie/NA
209	Mike Washington Jr.	RB	204.6	11	24.5%	34%	rookie/NA
229	Kirk Cousins	QB	221.0			13%	1.4 car/g
310	Dont'e Thornton Jr.	WR	228.1	10	21.0%	17%	9.9% tgt
324	Malik Benson	WR	231.0				rookie/NA

Volume & script

59.6 plays/g (10th) · 33.3 pass att (8th) · 55.8% pass rate (8th) · 228.6 pass yds (16th) · 26.4 carries (25th) · 108.3 rush yds (30th) · 1.71 TD/g (28th)

This is a genuinely pass-first script — 55.8% pass rate against a 54% league mean — so the receiving corps, not the backfield, is where the fantasy points concentrate, and the pace is real — 59.6 snaps/g (10th) manufactures extra possessions for everyone. The 28th-ranked scoring rate (1.71 TD/g) is the cap here — touchdown-dependent ceilings get harder to hit.

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

Brock Bowers 23.5% tgt / aDOT 6.4 / max 46.3 · Tre Tucker 18.9% tgt / aDOT 10.2 / max 43.9 · Michael Mayer 14.8% tgt / aDOT 4.8 / max 17.9 · Ashton Jeanty 15.7 car/g, 3.2 rec/g, max 37.5

Brock Bowers is the focal point — a 23.5% target share in 2025 (rock-steady, cv 0.28), at a 6.4-yard aDOT (short-area routes), peaking at 46.3 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Tre Tucker (18.9%). In the backfield Ashton Jeanty profiled as a true workhorse (15.7 carries/g, and he caught 3.2 balls/g); ceiling week 37.5 DK.

2026 outlook: what changes

Scheme watch — “New season, and you guys have a lot of the same parts of the team, but certainly some new members of your coaching staff, Clint Kubiak, your offensive coordinator, now the head coach of the Las Vegas Raiders” (@dhananizain). Volume shift: Clay projects 33.3 pass att/g in 2026 vs 34.2 actual in 2025 (-0.9) — holding steady on pass volume. Vacated opportunity: ~12.0% of the 2025 target volume turned over (a largely intact target tree) — out: T.Lockett (12.0%, gone). In: Jalen Nailor (from MIN); Kirk Cousins (from ATL) · rookies: Fernando Mendoza. Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): Ashton Jeanty 16.6/g proj vs 14.8/g in 2025 (+1.8, roughly steady); Brock Bowers 14.2/g proj vs 15.0/g in 2025 (-0.8, roughly steady); Tre Tucker 8.1/g proj vs 9.7/g in 2025 (-1.6, roughly steady); Jalen Nailor 6.8/g proj vs 6.0/g in 2025 (+0.8, roughly steady, joins from MIN).

Ceiling & upside

Ashton Jeanty p95 37 (16.6% spike) · Brock Bowers p95 34 (17.5% spike)

2 players clear the alpha-ceiling bar, led by Ashton Jeanty (p95 37, hits a spike week 16.6% of the time). This is the currency that wins best ball — these are the weekly outcomes that drag a lineup into the 90th percentile.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: Brock Bowers (98%), Ashton Jeanty (92%), Tre Tucker (58%). Pure spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): Tre Tucker, Jalen Nailor, Mike Washington Jr. — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Fernando Mendoza + Brock Bowers / Tre Tucker — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r \approx 0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is ARI@LV — a lower-variance finals game (tail rank #14); the natural bring-back is a ARI pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byes fall in Week 13, and the playoff run is W15 vs DEN, W16 vs TEN.

Coachspeak & film

On the team: “Now, yards before contact per rush can be a running back stat if they are messing around behind the line of scrimmage, but in the case of the Raiders, we can say with some confidence that it's the play of the offensive line”. On Brock Bowers: “Yeah, you talk about Brock Bowers and the Raiders, Mike, are expecting Bowers to bounce back in a big way” (@dhananizain). On Mike Washington Jr.: “Even after Las Vegas drafted former Arkansas running back Mike Washington Jr” (@smitchell17). On Kirk Cousins: “- Las Vegas Raiders: This is such an easy one to get a back-stack in since you can literally get both Mendoza and presumable starter Kirk Cousins pretty late in drafts” (@smitchell17).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around Ashton Jeanty (board #14, ADP 12.0), with Brock Bowers as the correlated ceiling pieces. Let the market overpay for Dont'e Thornton Jr., Malik Benson.

Risks & flags

structural: a pass-first, low-carry script makes the backfield a committee/touchdown-variance bet

Los Angeles Chargers (LAC)

Bye W7 · Playoffs: W15 SF · W16 MIA · W17 KC@LAC (finals tail #9) · 3 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A balanced, low-snap attack and a middle scoring offense (2.41 implied TD/g, 14th). 3 alpha-ceiling players (p95≥33); best board asset is Omarion Hampton at #16.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
16	Omarion Hampton	RB	17.3	37	16.8%	93%	11.8% tgt
38	Ladd McConkey	WR	33.5	33	17.3%	86%	20.6% tgt
76	Justin Herbert	QB	82.3	34	14.1%	67%	5.5 car/g
90	Quentin Johnston	WR	90.8	26	19.2%	67%	20.0% tgt
145	Keaton Mitchell	RB	142.7	11	24.7%	35%	rookie/NA
146	Oronde Gadsden II	TE	140.5	20	20.7%	54%	14.1% tgt
188	Tre' Harris	WR	185.5	16	21.5%	44%	9.1% tgt
196	David Njoku	TE	188.8	16	22.5%	42%	12.4% tgt
215	Kimani Vidal	RB	210.0	8	21.1%	22%	6.7% tgt

Volume & script

57.8 plays/g (32nd) · 31.1 pass att (21st) · 53.7% pass rate (18th) · 226.2 pass yds (20th) · 26.8 carries (21st) · 120.5 rush yds (16th) · 2.41 TD/g (14th)

A balanced script (53.7% pass) spreads opportunity without a strong structural lean either way, but the deliberate pace (57.8 snaps/g, 32nd) caps the raw opportunity to go around. Scoring sits mid-pack (2.41 TD/g, 14th).

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

Ladd McConkey 20.6% tgt / aDOT 9.9 / max 26.0 · Quentin Johnston 20.0% tgt / aDOT 11.6 / max 24.9 · Oronde Gadsden II 14.1% tgt / aDOT 8.9 / max 32.4 · Kimani Vidal 12.8 car/g, 1.4 rec/g, max 25.8

Ladd McConkey is the focal point — a 20.6% target share in 2025 (fairly stable, cv 0.39), at a 9.9-yard aDOT (all-levels routes), peaking at 26.0 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Quentin Johnston (20.0%). In the backfield Kimani Vidal profiled as the lead of a rotation (12.8 carries/g, with a thin receiving role); ceiling week 25.8 DK. Small-sample caveat: Trey Lance (4g) missed time, so the rates ride a partial season.

2026 outlook: what changes

Scheme watch — “The bad news for Chargers fans is that O’Leary has only been a defensive coordinator for one season” (@thepowerrank). Volume shift: Clay projects 31.1 pass att/g in 2026 vs 37.0 actual in 2025 (-5.9) — projected for lower pass volume / more run than 2025. Vacated opportunity: ~22.7% of the 2025 target volume turned over (meaningful turnover) — out: K.Allen (22.7%, gone). In: David Njoku (from CLE); Charlie Kolar (from BAL) · rookies: Keaton Mitchell. Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): Omarion Hampton 16.6/g proj vs 13.9/g in 2025 (+2.7, trending up); Ladd McConkey 12.9/g proj vs 11.4/g in 2025 (+1.5, roughly steady); Justin Herbert 17.6/g proj vs 18.9/g in 2025 (-1.3, roughly steady); Quentin Johnston 9.8/g proj vs 12.9/g in 2025 (-3.1, projected to regress).

Ceiling & upside

Omarion Hampton p95 37 (16.8% spike) · Justin Herbert p95 34 (14.1% spike) · Ladd McConkey p95 33 (17.3% spike)

3 players clear the alpha-ceiling bar, led by Omarion Hampton (p95 37, hits a spike week 16.8% of the time). This is the currency that wins best ball — these are the weekly outcomes that drag a lineup into the 90th percentile. Highest-variance (boom/bust) of the group: Ladd McConkey — exactly the volatility you want on a bench that only counts its best weeks.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: Omarion Hampton (93%), Ladd McConkey (86%), Justin Herbert (67%). Pure spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): Quentin Johnston, Keaton Mitchell, Oronde Gadsden II — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Justin Herbert + Ladd McConkey / Quentin Johnston — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r \approx 0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is KC@LAC — a mid-tier finals game (tail rank #9); the natural bring-back is a KC pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byes fall in Week 7, and the playoff run is W15 vs SF, W16 vs MIA.

Coachspeak & film

On the team: “The bad news for Chargers fans is that O’Leary has only been a defensive coordinator for one season”. On Omarion Hampton: “And I know Amarion Hampton was hurt last year, but I watched basically every snap of Amarion Hampton when he was playing” (@fantasypts). On Ladd McConkey: “Ladd McConkey is Ryan Heath’s favorite bet to follow Jaxon Smith-Njigba’s Year 3 breakout Here’s how their Year 1 and Year 2 metrics stack up, and what conditions are setting McConkey up for the leap!” (@fantasypts). On Justin Herbert: “Justin Herbert should just have the best season of his career” (@fantasypts).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around Omarion Hampton (board #16, ADP 17.3), with Ladd McConkey, Justin Herbert as the correlated ceiling pieces. Let the market overpay for Charlie Kolar, KeAndre Lambert-Smith.

Risks & flags

Justin Herbert — trap: Trap take Michael Wilson instead (+16). 4.2

Philadelphia Eagles (PHI)

Bye W10 · Playoffs: W15 SEA · W16 HOU · W17 PHI@SF (finals tail #8) · 3 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A run-leaning, average-pace attack and a top scoring offense (2.65 implied TD/g, 7th). 3 alpha-ceiling players (p95≥33); best board asset is Saquon Barkley at #17.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
17	Saquon Barkley	RB	13.5	35	16.8%	87%	13.3% tgt
30	DeVonta Smith	WR	28.1	35	17.0%	89%	25.1% tgt
69	Jalen Hurts	QB	75.3	33	9.2%	92%	6.5 car/g
89	Makai Lemon	WR	81.6	29	17.8%	73%	rookie/NA
123	Dallas Goedert	TE	124.0	27	18.8%	85%	20.7% tgt
182	Tank Bigsby	RB	178.5	11	23.9%	33%	4.3% tgt
210	Dontayvion Wicks	WR	210.0	12	24.4%	26%	12.8% tgt
212	Eli Stowers	TE	199.9	8	21.3%	12%	rookie/NA
254	Will Shipley	RB	227.4	6	19.8%	8%	4.9% tgt

Volume & script

58.9 plays/g (18th) · 29.4 pass att (31st) · 49.8% pass rate (31st) · 222.3 pass yds (25th) · 29.6 carries (3rd) · 126.8 rush yds (6th) · 2.65 TD/g (7th)

A run-leaning script (49.8% pass vs 54% league) tilts value toward the backfield and compresses the passing pie. Most important for best ball: 2.65 implied TD/g (7th) is a top-tier scoring environment that raises every weekly ceiling.

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

DeVonta Smith 25.1% tgt / aDOT 11.1 / max 36.3 · Dallas Goedert 20.7% tgt / aDOT 7.5 / max 29.0 · Dontayvion Wicks 12.8% tgt / aDOT 11.2 / max 28.0 · Saquon Barkley 18.1 car/g, 2.4 rec/g, max 36.4

DeVonta Smith is the focal point — a 25.1% target share in 2025 (fairly stable, cv 0.43), at a 11.1-yard aDOT (all-levels routes), peaking at 36.3 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Dallas Goedert (20.7%). In the backfield Saquon Barkley profiled as a true workhorse (18.1 carries/g, with a thin receiving role); ceiling week 36.4 DK. Small-sample caveat: Tanner McKee (4g) missed time, so the rates ride a partial season.

2026 outlook: what changes

Scheme watch — “New Eagles offensive coordinator Sean Mannion hasn't called plays in the NFL before, but he was an offensive coordinator at the East West Shrine Bowl this year” (@syedschemes). Volume shift: Clay projects 29.4 pass att/g in 2026 vs 31.7 actual in 2025 (-2.3) — projected for lower pass volume / more run than 2025. Vacated opportunity: ~33.3% of the 2025 target volume turned over (meaningful turnover) — out: A.Brown (25.8%, to NE), J.Dotson (7.5%, to ATL). In: Dontayvion Wicks (from GB) · rookies: Makai Lemon. Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): Saquon Barkley 16.1/g proj vs 15.3/g in 2025 (+0.8, roughly steady); DeVonta Smith 14.0/g proj vs 12.4/g in 2025 (+1.6, roughly steady); Jalen Hurts 19.8/g proj vs 19.0/g in 2025 (+0.8, roughly steady); Dallas Goedert 10.5/g proj vs 13.0/g in 2025 (-2.5, projected to regress).

Ceiling & upside

Saquon Barkley p95 35 (16.8% spike) · DeVonta Smith p95 35 (17.0% spike) · Jalen Hurts p95 33 (9.2% spike)

3 players clear the alpha-ceiling bar, led by Saquon Barkley (p95 35, hits a spike week 16.8% of the time). This is the currency that wins best ball — these are the weekly outcomes that drag a lineup into the 90th percentile. Highest-variance (boom/bust) of the group: DeVonta Smith — exactly the volatility you want on a bench that only counts its best weeks.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: Jalen Hurts (92%), DeVonta Smith (89%), Saquon Barkley (87%). Pure spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): Tank Bigsby, Dontayvion Wicks, Eli Stowers — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Jalen Hurts + DeVonta Smith / Makai Lemon — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r \approx 0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is PHI@SF — a mid-tier finals game (tail rank #8); the natural bring-back is a SF pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byes fall in Week 10, and the playoff run is W15 vs SEA, W16 vs HOU.

Coachspeak & film

On the team: “I want to see his usage kind of like a Zach Bond type two years ago with the Eagles, where you're playing linebacker, able to work down to the edge, because you want him attacking running backs from a distance”. On Makai Lemon: “Makai Lemon's good, and I can get access to Makai Lemon right now in the eighth round in FFPC drafts” (@fantasypts). On Dontayvion Wicks: “A, Wicks, I just think he has a very unique skill set of being able to get in and out of breaks and be really efficient at the line of scrimmage” (@dhananizain). On Will Shipley: “And during that bye week, you know, we read Duraco, we read John Shipley” (@joshnorris).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around Saquon Barkley (board #17, ADP 13.5), with DeVonta Smith, Jalen Hurts as the correlated ceiling pieces. Let the market overpay for Eli Stowers, Will Shipley.

Risks & flags

No specific risk overlays on this group; the main risk is generic (price vs the field).

Baltimore Ravens (BAL)

Bye W13 • Playoffs: W15 PIT • W16 CLE • W17 BAL@CIN (finals tail #2) • 3 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A run-leaning, average-pace attack and a top scoring offense (2.71 implied TD/g, 6th). 3 alpha-ceiling players (p95≥33); best board asset is Derrick Henry at #18.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
18	Derrick Henry	RB	20.4	37	17.0%	86%	6.3% tgt
37	Zay Flowers	WR	36.5	36	17.4%	91%	30.0% tgt
47	Lamar Jackson	QB	51.8	37	12.5%	97%	5.2 car/g
133	Mark Andrews	TE	131.3	25	18.8%	81%	17.0% tgt
211	Justice Hill	RB	213.4	18	19.8%	48%	12.4% tgt
234	Elijah Sarratt	WR	224.3	13	23.8%	27%	rookie/NA
297	Rashod Bateman	WR	227.4	21	19.9%	55%	12.1% tgt
306	Devontez Walker	WR	228.2	8	20.4%	13%	6.8% tgt
339	Tyler Huntley	QB	230.5				4.8 car/g

Volume & script

59.1 plays/g (16th) • 27.5 pass att (32nd) • 46.5% pass rate (32nd) • 228.5 pass yds (17th) • 31.6 carries (1st) • 152.1 rush yds (1st) • 2.71 TD/g (6th)

A run-leaning script (46.5% pass vs 54% league) tilts value toward the backfield and compresses the passing pie. Most important for best ball: 2.71 implied TD/g (6th) is a top-tier scoring environment that raises every weekly ceiling.

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

Zay Flowers 30.0% tgt / aDOT 10.1 / max 32.8 • Mark Andrews 17.0% tgt / aDOT 7.3 / max 27.1 • Rashod Bateman 12.1% tgt / aDOT 12.0 / max 17.3 • Derrick Henry 18.1 car/g, 0.9 rec/g, max 48.6

Zay Flowers is the focal point — a 30.0% target share in 2025 (rock-steady, cv 0.3), at a 10.1-yard aDOT (all-levels routes), peaking at 32.8 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Mark Andrews (17.0%). In the backfield Derrick Henry profiled as a true workhorse (18.1 carries/g, with a thin receiving role); ceiling week 48.6 DK. Small-sample caveat: Devontez Walker (5g), Tyler Huntley (5g) missed time, so the rates ride a partial season.

2026 outlook: what changes

Volume shift: Clay projects 27.5 pass att/g in 2026 vs 27.6 actual in 2025 (-0.1) — holding steady on pass volume. Vacated opportunity: ~18.3% of the 2025 target volume turned over (a largely intact target tree) — out: D.Hopkins (9.5%, to FA), I.Likely (8.8%, to NYG). In: Ja'Kobi Lane (from WAS). Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): Derrick Henry 16.1/g proj vs 18.0/g in 2025 (-1.9, roughly steady); Zay Flowers 14.2/g proj vs 15.0/g in 2025 (-0.8, roughly steady); Lamar Jackson 20.0/g proj vs 17.0/g in 2025 (+3.0, trending up); Mark Andrews 10.1/g proj vs 7.7/g in 2025 (+2.4, trending up).

Ceiling & upside

Derrick Henry p95 37 (17.0% spike) • Lamar Jackson p95 37 (12.5% spike) • Zay Flowers p95 36 (17.4% spike)

3 players clear the alpha-ceiling bar, led by Derrick Henry (p95 37, hits a spike week 17.0% of the time). This is the currency that wins best ball — these are the weekly outcomes that drag a lineup into the 90th percentile.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: Lamar Jackson (97%), Zay Flowers (91%), Derrick Henry (86%). Pure spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): Justice Hill, Elijah Sarratt, Rashod Bateman — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Lamar Jackson + Zay Flowers / Mark Andrews — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r \approx 0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is BAL@CIN — a top-tier blow-up game (tail rank #2); the natural bring-back is a CIN pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byes fall in Week 13, and the playoff run is W15 vs PIT, W16 vs CLE.

CoachSpeak & film

On the team: “This is the most talented pass rusher the Ravens have had in years, and remember this, the last two fully healthy years he's had, 23 and 24, 17 and a half sacks each year”. On Lamar Jackson: “You lose Linderbaum, draft a guard inside the top 14, but for the most part, it's kind of the same thing with Lamar Jackson in terms of the skill guys” (@joshnorris). On Mark Andrews: “I don't think you can make this trade, and Andrew Berry wouldn't have made this trade, without Jared Burse” (@clevta). On Ja'Kobi Lane: “Antonio has it, man, in the biggest way. - New Ravens OC Declan Doyle "Taking Note", of rookie standout WR Ja'Kobi Lane after first week of Baltimore's OTAs” (@smitchell17).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around Derrick Henry (board #18, ADP 20.4), with Zay Flowers, Lamar Jackson as the correlated ceiling pieces. Let the market overpay for Rashod Bateman, Devontez Walker.

Risks & flags

Derrick Henry — age: Age flag; zero receiving floor is the 2nd fragility. 11

Arizona Cardinals (ARI)

Bye W14 · Playoffs: W15 NYJ · W16 NO · W17 ARI@LV (finals tail #14) · 2 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A pass-first, low-snap attack and a muted scoring offense (1.71 implied TD/g, 28th). 2 alpha-ceiling players (p95≥33); best board asset is Jeremiyah Love at #20.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
20	Jeremiyah Love	RB	26.5	37	16.9%	91%	rookie/NA
27	Trey McBride	TE	22.8	36	16.9%	100%	27.9% tgt
73	Marvin Harrison Jr.	WR	66.4	30	17.5%	77%	18.2% tgt
86	Michael Wilson	WR	81.1	26	18.5%	65%	15.8% tgt
163	Tyler Allgeier	RB	157.2	15	21.8%	43%	5.5% tgt
165	Jacoby Brissett	QB	166.9			28%	2.7 car/g
230	James Conner	RB	220.9				9.9% tgt
252	Gardner Minshew II	QB	228.5				rookie/NA
261	Carson Beck	QB	226.8	30	14.7%	44%	rookie/NA

Volume & script

58.2 plays/g (26th) · 34.3 pass att (2nd) · 58.9% pass rate (1st) · 223.9 pass yds (24th) · 23.9 carries (32nd) · 103.1 rush yds (32nd) · 1.71 TD/g (28th)

This is a genuinely pass-first script — 58.9% pass rate against a 54% league mean — so the receiving corps, not the backfield, is where the fantasy points concentrate, but the deliberate pace (58.2 snaps/g, 26th) caps the raw opportunity to go around. The 28th-ranked scoring rate (1.71 TD/g) is the cap here — touchdown-dependent ceilings get harder to hit.

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

Trey McBride 27.9% tgt / aDOT 6.6 / max 40.4 · Marvin Harrison Jr. 18.2% tgt / aDOT 12.8 / max 22.6 · Michael Wilson 15.8% tgt / aDOT 11.8 / max 40.2 · James Conner 10.7 car/g, 2.7 rec/g, max 14.4

Trey McBride is the focal point — a 27.9% target share in 2025 (rock-steady, cv 0.19), at a 6.6-yard aDOT (short-area routes), peaking at 40.4 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Marvin Harrison Jr. (18.2%), Michael Wilson (15.8%). In the backfield James Conner profiled as a committee back (10.7 carries/g, with a thin receiving role); ceiling week 14.4 DK.

2026 outlook: what changes

Scheme watch — “However, Hackett got hired as the offensive coordinator in Arizona” (@thepowerrank). Volume shift: Clay projects 34.3 pass att/g in 2026 vs 41.8 actual in 2025 (-7.5) — projected for lower pass volume / more run than 2025. Vacated opportunity: ~23.6% of the 2025 target volume turned over (meaningful turnover) — out: M.Carter (7.3%, gone), E.Higgins (6.0%, gone), G.Dortch (5.3%, to DET), Z.Knight (5.0%, gone). In: Tyler Allgeier (from ATL); Kendrick Bourne (from SF) · rookies: Jeremiyah Love. Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): Trey McBride 15.0/g proj vs 19.1/g in 2025 (-4.1, projected to regress); Marvin Harrison Jr. 11.4/g proj vs 10.4/g in 2025 (+1.0, roughly steady); Michael Wilson 9.8/g proj vs 13.5/g in 2025 (-3.7, projected to regress); Tyler Allgeier 5.1/g proj vs 7.2/g in 2025 (-2.1, projected to regress, joins from ATL).

Ceiling & upside

Jeremiyah Love p95 37 (16.9% spike) · Trey McBride p95 36 (16.9% spike)

2 players clear the alpha-ceiling bar, led by Jeremiyah Love (p95 37, hits a spike week 16.9% of the time). This is the currency that wins best ball — these are the weekly outcomes that drag a lineup into the 90th percentile.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: Trey McBride (100%), Jeremiyah Love (91%), Marvin Harrison Jr. (77%). Pure spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): Michael Wilson, Tyler Allgeier, Kendrick Bourne — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Jacoby Brissett + Trey McBride / Marvin Harrison Jr. — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r \approx 0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is ARI@LV — a lower-variance finals game (tail rank #14); the natural bring-back is a LV pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byes fall in Week 14, and the playoff run is W15 vs NYJ, W16 vs NO.

Coachspeak & film

On the team: “The Broncos defensive coordinator, Vance Joseph, spent four seasons with Arizona as their defensive coordinator”. On Jeremiyah Love: “ADP RB6 Ashton Jeanty, RB7 De'Von Achane, RB13 Jeremiyah Love are good at football, but could easily be in bottom-10 scoring offenses” (@ihartitz). On Jacoby Brissett: “Jacoby Brissett is their future quarterback” (@smitchell17). On Kendrick Bourne: “12.6 of 6 from the free throw line to go along with 13 rebounds, and again, when you see the disparity and how that's borne out, 6 offensive boards just doing Angel Reese things” (@ahaanrungta).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around Jeremiyah Love (board #20, ADP 26.5), with Trey McBride as the correlated ceiling pieces. Let the market overpay for Gardner Minshew II, Carson Beck.

Risks & flags

Michael Wilson — contingency: Leveraged insurance: +21.5 pts if Marvin Harrison misses time. 9 • structural: a pass-first, low-carry script makes the backfield a committee/touchdown-variance bet

Houston Texans (HOU)

Bye W8 • Playoffs: W15 JAX • W16 PHI • W17 GB@HOU (finals tail #10) • 1 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A balanced, average-pace attack and a middle scoring offense (1.88 implied TD/g, 23rd). 1 alpha-ceiling player (p95≥33); best board asset is Nico Collins at #21.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
21	Nico Collins	WR	23.6	37	16.9%	94%	24.1% tgt
51	David Montgomery	RB	50.9	28	19.2%	72%	5.8% tgt
132	C.J. Stroud	QB	139.0	30	14.7%	41%	3.2 car/g
136	Jayden Higgins	WR	132.2	23	19.5%	59%	13.0% tgt
150	Woody Marks	RB	143.4	19	20.1%	50%	6.9% tgt
168	Dalton Schultz	TE	171.4	22	19.9%	60%	17.9% tgt
186	Tank Dell	WR	187.0	18	21.3%	50%	rookie/NA
245	Jaylin Noel	WR	227.5	11	21.8%	24%	7.1% tgt
267	Xavier Hutchinson	WR	230.2	11	21.2%	19%	12.9% tgt

Volume & script

58.9 plays/g (17th) • 32.4 pass att (13th) • 55.0% pass rate (12th) • 232.1 pass yds (11th) • 26.5 carries (23rd) • 113.6 rush yds (25th) • 1.88 TD/g (23rd)

A balanced script (55.0% pass) spreads opportunity without a strong structural lean either way. Scoring sits mid-pack (1.88 TD/g, 23rd).

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

Nico Collins 24.1% tgt / aDOT 12.4 / max 26.4 • Dalton Schultz 17.9% tgt / aDOT 6.1 / max 21.6 • Jayden Higgins 13.0% tgt / aDOT 12.4 / max 16.8 • Woody Marks 12.7 car/g, 1.4 rec/g, max 27.9

Nico Collins is the focal point — a 24.1% target share in 2025 (rock-steady, cv 0.33), at a 12.4-yard aDOT (downfield routes), peaking at 26.4 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Dalton Schultz (17.9%). In the backfield Woody Marks profiled as the lead of a rotation (12.7 carries/g, with a thin receiving role); ceiling week 27.9 DK.

2026 outlook: what changes

Volume shift: Clay projects 32.4 pass att/g in 2026 vs 37.0 actual in 2025 (-4.6) — projected for lower pass volume / more run than 2025. Vacated opportunity: ~10.8% of the 2025 target volume turned over (a largely intact target tree) — out: C.Kirk (10.8%, to SF). In: David Montgomery (from DET) • rookies: Tank Dell. Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): Nico Collins 14.8/g proj vs 15.0/g in 2025 (-0.2, roughly steady); David Montgomery 11.5/g proj vs 9.9/g in 2025 (+1.6, roughly steady, joins from DET); C.J. Stroud 15.3/g proj vs 14.9/g in 2025 (+0.4, roughly steady); Jayden Higgins 8.2/g proj vs 7.8/g in 2025 (+0.4, roughly steady).

Ceiling & upside

Nico Collins p95 37 (16.9% spike)

1 players clear the alpha-ceiling bar, led by Nico Collins (p95 37, hits a spike week 16.9% of the time). This is the currency that wins best ball — these are the weekly outcomes that drag a lineup into the 90th percentile. Highest-variance (boom/bust) of the group: Nico Collins — exactly the volatility you want on a bench that only counts its best weeks.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: Nico Collins (94%), David Montgomery (72%), Dalton Schultz (60%). Pure spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): David Montgomery, Jayden Higgins, Woody Marks — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is C.J. Stroud + Nico Collins / Jayden Higgins — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r \approx 0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is GB@HOU — a mid-tier finals game (tail rank #10); the natural bring-back is a GB pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Bys fall in Week 8, and the playoff run is W15 vs JAX, W16 vs PHI.

Coachspeak & film

On the team: “The 2024 Houston Texans ran 12 personnel at the 3rd highest rate in the NFL at 31.5%”. On Nico Collins: “Isn't that the case for Drake London + Nico Collins as top-10 WRs and Round 2 picks despite the QB questions?” (@ihartitz). On C.J. Stroud: “Stroud supporter, I feel like Nate has done a really good job of, even when things are going south from a production standpoint or perception standpoint, saying, this quarterback is still playing well” (@sammonsonnfl). On Woody Marks: “Houston has an excellent receiving back in Woody Marks that was basically drafted FOR that reason” (@smitchell17).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around Nico Collins (board #21, ADP 23.6). Let the market overpay for Jaylin Noel, Xavier Hutchinson.

Risks & flags

No specific risk overlays on this group; the main risk is generic (price vs the field).

New England Patriots (NE)

Bye W11 • Playoffs: W15 KC • W16 NYJ • W17 DEN@NE (finals tail #6) • 2 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A run-leaning, low-snap attack and a top scoring offense (2.65 implied TD/g, 8th). 2 alpha-ceiling players (p95≥33); best board asset is A.J. Brown at #23.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
23	A.J. Brown	WR	19.4	37	17.4%	92%	28.0% tgt
59	Drake Maye	QB	65.0	37	13.8%	95%	3.0% tgt
63	TreVeyon Henderson	RB	57.6	29	17.5%	77%	10.1% tgt
78	Rhamondre Stevenson	RB	75.6	27	18.2%	71%	10.7% tgt
121	Romeo Doubs	WR	119.4	27	19.0%	69%	19.5% tgt
153	Hunter Henry	TE	156.2	24	19.8%	67%	16.7% tgt
213	Kayshon Boutte	WR	207.2	14	24.6%	36%	13.5% tgt
276	DeMario Douglas	WR	228.4	12	21.8%	25%	10.2% tgt
315	Mack Hollins	WR	228.3	8	20.0%	12%	16.0% tgt

Volume & script

58.4 plays/g (25th) • 30.6 pass att (25th) • 52.4% pass rate (24th) • 240.9 pass yds (7th) • 27.8 carries (10th) • 126.5 rush yds (9th) • 2.65 TD/g (8th)

A run-leaning script (52.4% pass vs 54% league) tilts value toward the backfield and compresses the passing pie, but the deliberate pace (58.4 snaps/g, 25th) caps the raw opportunity to go around. Most important for best ball: 2.65 implied TD/g (8th) is a top-tier scoring environment that raises every weekly ceiling.

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

A.J. Brown 28.0% tgt / aDOT 12.2 / max 38.2 • Romeo Doubs 19.5% tgt / aDOT 12.4 / max 29.8 • Hunter Henry 16.7% tgt / aDOT 8.2 / max 29.0 • Rhamondre Stevenson 10.5 car/g, 2.4 rec/g, max 38.3

A.J. Brown (2025 with PHI) is the focal point — a 28.0% target share in 2025 (fairly stable, cv 0.4), at a 12.2-yard aDOT (downfield routes), peaking at 38.2 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Romeo Doubs (19.5%), Hunter Henry (16.7%). In the backfield Rhamondre Stevenson profiled as a committee back (10.5 carries/g, with a thin receiving role); ceiling week 38.3 DK.

2026 outlook: what changes

Volume shift: Clay projects 30.6 pass att/g in 2026 vs 33.0 actual in 2025 (-2.4) — projected for lower pass volume / more run than 2025. Vacated opportunity: ~30.4% of the 2025 target volume turned over (meaningful turnover) — out: S.Diggs (20.4%, to FA), A.Hooper (5.5%, gone), K.Williams (4.5%, gone). In: A.J. Brown (from PHI); Romeo Doubs (from GB). Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): A.J. Brown 14.7/g proj vs 15.0/g in 2025 (-0.3, roughly steady, joins from PHI); Drake Maye 19.9/g proj vs 20.7/g in 2025 (-0.8, roughly steady); TreVeyon Henderson 12.5/g proj vs 10.9/g in 2025 (+1.6, roughly steady); Rhamondre Stevenson 11.5/g proj vs 12.9/g in 2025 (-1.4, roughly steady).

Ceiling & upside

A.J. Brown p95 37 (17.4% spike) • Drake Maye p95 37 (13.8% spike)

2 players clear the alpha-ceiling bar, led by A.J. Brown (p95 37, hits a spike week 17.4% of the time). This is the currency that wins best ball — these are the weekly outcomes that drag a lineup into the 90th percentile.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: Drake Maye (95%), A.J. Brown (92%), TreVeyon Henderson (77%). Pure spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): Rhamondre Stevenson, Romeo Doubs, Hunter Henry — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Drake Maye + A.J. Brown / Romeo Doubs — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r \approx 0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is DEN@NE — a top-tier blow-up game (tail rank #6); the natural bring-back is a DEN pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byes fall in Week 11, and the playoff run is W15 vs KC, W16 vs NYJ.

Coachspeak & film

On the team: “Zach did an awesome job scheming him up in the red zone in the New England game”. On Kayshon Boutte: “Is Kayshon Boutte going to be the absolute stone nuts value at an ADP of 207.1 when/if A.J.” (@smitchell17).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around A.J. Brown (board #23, ADP 19.4), with Drake Maye as the correlated ceiling pieces. Let the market overpay for DeMario Douglas, Mack Hollins.

Risks & flags

No specific risk overlays on this group; the main risk is generic (price vs the field).

New York Jets (NYJ)

Bye W13 • Playoffs: W15 ARI • W16 NE • W17 MIN@NYJ (finals tail #7) • 2 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A balanced, low-snap attack and a middle scoring offense (2.0 implied TD/g, 22nd). 2 alpha-ceiling players (p95≥33); best board asset is Breece Hall at #26.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
26	Breece Hall	RB	30.5	37	17.3%	90%	11.2% tgt
33	Garrett Wilson	WR	39.0	37	16.6%	94%	35.6% tgt
148	Kenyon Sadiq	TE	151.4	25	19.6%	75%	rookie/NA
155	Omar Cooper Jr.	WR	149.3	19	20.9%	51%	rookie/NA
171	Geno Smith	QB	174.3	25	9.2%	33%	2.7 car/g
190	Adonai Mitchell	WR	196.7	20	20.1%	54%	15.3% tgt
202	Braelon Allen	RB	200.2	15	21.8%	44%	5.2% tgt
328	Isaiah Davis	RB	228.0	8	21.0%	23%	8.6% tgt
354	Mason Taylor	TE	229.9	11	22.9%	23%	17.2% tgt

Volume & script

58.1 plays/g (29th) • 31.2 pass att (18th) • 53.7% pass rate (17th) • 224.3 pass yds (23rd) • 26.9 carries (19th) • 116.1 rush yds (21st) • 2.0 TD/g (22nd)

A balanced script (53.7% pass) spreads opportunity without a strong structural lean either way, but the deliberate pace (58.1 snaps/g, 29th) caps the raw opportunity to go around. Scoring sits mid-pack (2.0 TD/g, 22nd).

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

Garrett Wilson 35.6% tgt / aDOT 8.9 / max 24.4 • Mason Taylor 17.2% tgt / aDOT 5.7 / max 15.7 • Adonai Mitchell 15.3% tgt / aDOT 14.9 / max 27.2 • Breece Hall 15.2 car/g, 2.2 rec/g, max 35.9

Garrett Wilson is the focal point — a 35.6% target share in 2025 (rock-steady, cv 0.28), at a 8.9-yard aDOT (all-levels routes), peaking at 24.4 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Mason Taylor (17.2%), Adonai Mitchell (15.3%). In the backfield Breece Hall profiled as a true workhorse (15.2 carries/g, with a thin receiving role); ceiling week 35.9 DK. Small-sample caveat: Garrett Wilson (7g) missed time, so the rates ride a partial season.

2026 outlook: what changes

Scheme watch — “However, he was still a hot commodity because Aaron Rodgers was going to the New York Jets, and the Jets were more than happy to hire his buddy to be the offensive coordinator” (@thepowerrank). Volume shift: Clay projects 31.2 pass att/g in 2026 vs 32.9 actual in 2025 (-1.7) — projected for lower pass volume / more run than 2025. Vacated opportunity: ~40.5% of the 2025 target volume turned over (major turnover) — out: J.Metchie (11.3%, to CAR), I.Williams (8.5%, gone), J.Ruckert (6.9%, gone), J.Reynolds (5.2%, gone). In: Geno Smith (from LV); Adonai Mitchell (from IND) • rookies: Kenyon Sadiq, Omar Cooper Jr.. Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): Breece Hall 16.3/g proj vs 13.9/g in 2025 (+2.4, trending up); Garrett Wilson 15.0/g proj vs 14.2/g in 2025 (+0.8, roughly steady); Geno Smith 14.5/g proj vs 12.9/g in 2025 (+1.6, roughly steady, joins from LV); Adonai Mitchell 6.7/g proj vs 5.7/g in 2025 (+1.0, roughly steady, joins from IND).

Ceiling & upside

Breece Hall p95 37 (17.3% spike) • Garrett Wilson p95 37 (16.6% spike)

2 players clear the alpha-ceiling bar, led by Breece Hall (p95 37, hits a spike week 17.3% of the time). This is the currency that wins best ball — these are the weekly outcomes that drag a lineup into the 90th percentile.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: Garrett Wilson (94%), Breece Hall (90%), Kenyon Sadiq (75%). Pure spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): Kenyon Sadiq, Omar Cooper Jr., Adonai Mitchell — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Geno Smith + Garrett Wilson / Kenyon Sadiq — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r \approx 0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is MIN@NYJ — a mid-tier finals game (tail rank #7); the natural bring-back is a MIN pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byes fall in Week 13, and the playoff run is W15 vs ARI, W16 vs NE.

Coachspeak & film

On the team: “However, he was still a hot commodity because Aaron Rodgers was going to the New York Jets, and the Jets were more than happy to hire his buddy to be the offensive coordinator”. On Breece Hall: “We debated players next to each other in ADP: + Breece Hall vs” (@haydenwinks). On Kenyon Sadiq: “He has the athletic tools in his body to be able to do that, so I'm really interested to see where does Kenyon Sadiq land in the 2026 NFL Draft” (@syedschemes). On Omar Cooper Jr.: “I don't think I'll be drafting much Omar Cooper” (@haydenwinks).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around Breece Hall (board #26, ADP 30.5), with Garrett Wilson as the correlated ceiling pieces. Let the market overpay for Isaiah Davis, Mason Taylor.

Risks & flags

No specific risk overlays on this group; the main risk is generic (price vs the field).

New Orleans Saints (NO)

Bye W8 • Playoffs: W15 TB • W16 ARI • W17 ATL@NO (finals tail #11) • 2 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A balanced, average-pace attack and a middle scoring offense (1.88 implied TD/g, 23rd). 2 alpha-ceiling players (p95≥33); best board asset is Chris Olave at #29.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
29	Chris Olave	WR	26.5	36	17.1%	91%	29.1% tgt
40	Travis Etienne Jr.	RB	34.0	33	17.3%	80%	10.1% tgt
74	Jordyn Tyson	WR	68.2	29	18.1%	76%	rookie/NA
116	Tyler Shough	QB	115.6	32	14.4%	54%	4.2 car/g
149	Juwan Johnson	TE	152.8	24	19.4%	65%	17.6% tgt
169	Alvin Kamara	RB	163.3	19	20.2%	49%	11.7% tgt
251	Audric Esteime	RB	232.3				9.1% tgt
265	Devin Neal	RB	228.2				7.8% tgt
301	Devaughn Vele	WR	229.6	13	25.1%	28%	13.6% tgt

Volume & script

59.4 plays/g (13th) • 32.2 pass att (14th) • 54.3% pass rate (15th) • 228.6 pass yds (15th) • 27.1 carries (16th) • 115.4 rush yds (22nd) • 1.88 TD/g (23rd)

A balanced script (54.3% pass) spreads opportunity without a strong structural lean either way. Scoring sits mid-pack (1.88 TD/g, 23rd).

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

Chris Olave 29.1% tgt / aDOT 11.8 / max 39.8 • Juwan Johnson 17.6% tgt / aDOT 7.6 / max 19.2 • Devaughn Vele 13.6% tgt / aDOT 10.8 / max 23.3 • Travis Etienne Jr. 15.0 car/g, 2.3 rec/g, max 31.5

Chris Olave is the focal point — a 29.1% target share in 2025 (rock-steady, cv 0.23), at a 11.8-yard aDOT (all-levels routes), peaking at 39.8 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Juwan Johnson (17.6%). In the backfield Travis Etienne Jr. (2025 with JAX) profiled as a true workhorse (15.0 carries/g, with a thin receiving role); ceiling week 31.5 DK. Small-sample caveat: Devaughn Vele (9g) missed time, so the rates ride a partial season.

2026 outlook: what changes

Volume shift: Clay projects 32.2 pass att/g in 2026 vs 37.7 actual in 2025 (-5.5) — projected for lower pass volume / more run than 2025. Vacated opportunity: ~13.4% of the 2025 target volume turned over (a largely intact target tree) — out: B.Cooks (9.0%, gone), K.Austin (4.4%, gone). In: Travis Etienne Jr. (from JAX); Noah Fant (from CIN) • rookies: Jordyn Tyson. Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): Chris Olave 14.2/g proj vs 17.4/g in 2025 (-3.2, projected to regress); Travis Etienne Jr. 14.3/g proj vs 15.7/g in 2025 (-1.4, roughly steady, joins from JAX); Tyler Shough 16.3/g proj vs 15.3/g in 2025 (+1.0, roughly steady); Juwan Johnson 8.5/g proj vs 10.7/g in 2025 (-2.2, projected to regress).

Ceiling & upside

Chris Olave p95 36 (17.1% spike) • Travis Etienne Jr. p95 33 (17.3% spike)

2 players clear the alpha-ceiling bar, led by Chris Olave (p95 36, hits a spike week 17.1% of the time). This is the currency that wins best ball — these are the weekly outcomes that drag a lineup into the 90th percentile.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: Chris Olave (91%), Travis Etienne Jr. (80%), Jordyn Tyson (76%). Pure

spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): Jordyn Tyson, Juwan Johnson, Alvin Kamara — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Tyler Shough + Chris Olave / Jordyn Tyson — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r \approx 0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is ATL@NO — a mid-tier finals game (tail rank #11); the natural bring-back is a ATL pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byes fall in Week 8, and the playoff run is W15 vs TB, W16 vs ARI.

Coachspeak & film

On the team: “But they came to work me out in New Orleans, went to dinner, and there was just friction between the head coach, general manager, the owners”. On Jordyn Tyson: “They added Jordan Tyson in the draft to go alongside Chris Olave” (@fantasypts). On Alvin Kamara: “I’m assuming Alvin Kamara is going to retire or get released” (@ffdataroma). On Oscar Delp: “You know, a player like Oscar Delp from Georgia, who was drafted in the third round by the New Orleans Saints” (@dbro_ffb).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around Chris Olave (board #29, ADP 26.5), with Travis Etienne Jr. as the correlated ceiling pieces. Let the market overpay for Audric Estime, Devin Neal.

Risks & flags

Travis Etienne Jr. — trap: Trap take Kyren Williams instead (+20). 4.2 • Alvin Kamara — age: Age / role-decline flag. 11

New York Giants (NYG)

Bye W8 • Playoffs: W15 CLE • W16 DET • W17 DAL@NYG (finals tail #3) • 2 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A run-leaning, average-pace attack and a middle scoring offense (2.18 implied TD/g, 20th). 2 alpha-ceiling players (p95≥33); best board asset is Malik Nabers at #31.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
31	Malik Nabers	WR	36.5	37	17.7%	93%	27.1% tgt
46	Cam Skattebo	RB	45.2	32	17.2%	81%	12.8% tgt
94	Jaxson Dart	QB	98.6	35	13.2%	87%	6.1 car/g
127	Isaiah Likely	TE	122.5	24	19.4%	71%	13.0% tgt
138	Tyrone Tracy Jr.	RB	133.7	14	21.2%	40%	12.4% tgt
218	Malachi Fields	WR	211.5	8	20.4%	14%	rookie/NA
220	Darnell Mooney	WR	216.0	18	21.0%	47%	16.1% tgt
239	Odell Beckham Jr.	WR	224.4	9	21.0%	14%	rookie/NA
255	JuJu Smith-Schuster	WR	226.4	1	7.7%	6%	rookie/NA

Volume & script

58.6 plays/g (23rd) • 29.6 pass att (30th) • 50.6% pass rate (29th) • 217.0 pass yds (29th) • 28.9 carries (5th) • 129.9 rush yds (5th) • 2.18 TD/g (20th)

A run-leaning script (50.6% pass vs 54% league) tilts value toward the backfield and compresses the passing pie. Scoring sits mid-pack (2.18 TD/g, 20th).

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

Malik Nabers 27.1% tgt / aDOT 15.9 / max 40.7 • Theo Johnson 17.1% tgt / aDOT 8.3 / max 21.3 • Darnell Mooney 16.1% tgt / aDOT 14.2 / max 16.4 • Cam Skattebo 12.8 car/g, 3.0 rec/g, max 31.0

Malik Nabers is the focal point — a 27.1% target share in 2025 (fairly stable, cv 0.37), at a 15.9-yard aDOT (downfield routes), peaking at 40.7 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Theo Johnson (17.1%), Darnell Mooney (16.1%). In the backfield Cam Skattebo profiled as the lead of a rotation (12.8 carries/g, and he caught 3.0 balls/g); ceiling week 31.0 DK. Small-sample caveat: Malik Nabers (4g), Jameis Winston (3g) missed time, so the rates ride a partial season.

2026 outlook: what changes

Volume shift: Clay projects 29.6 pass att/g in 2026 vs 33.9 actual in 2025 (-4.3) — projected for lower pass volume / more run than 2025. Vacated opportunity: ~33.8% of the 2025 target volume turned over (meaningful turnover) — out: W.Robinson (28.5%, to TEN), D.Bellinger (5.3%, gone). In: Isaiah Likely (from BAL); Darnell Mooney (from ATL); Calvin Austin III (from PIT). Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): Malik Nabers 14.7/g proj vs 15.0/g in 2025 (-0.3, roughly steady); Cam Skattebo 14.4/g proj vs 15.8/g in 2025 (-1.4, roughly steady); Jaxson Dart 18.8/g proj vs 17.5/g in 2025 (+1.3, roughly steady); Isaiah Likely 9.2/g proj vs 5.7/g in 2025 (+3.5, trending up, joins from BAL).

Ceiling & upside

Malik Nabers p95 37 (17.7% spike) • Jaxson Dart p95 35 (13.2% spike)

2 players clear the alpha-ceiling bar, led by Malik Nabers (p95 37, hits a spike week 17.7% of the time). This is the currency that wins best ball — these are the weekly outcomes that drag a lineup into the 90th percentile.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: Malik Nabers (93%), Jaxson Dart (87%), Cam Skattebo (81%). Pure spike

profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): Isaiah Likely, Tyrone Tracy Jr., Malachi Fields — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Jaxson Dart + Malik Nabers / Isaiah Likely — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r \approx 0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is DAL@NYG — a top-tier blow-up game (tail rank #3); the natural bring-back is a DAL pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Bys fall in Week 8, and the playoff run is W15 vs CLE, W16 vs DET.

Coachspeak & film

On Jaxson Dart: “- New York Giants: The Giants also present one of the easier ways to get late-rd stacks if you decide to take Jaxson Dart in the earlier rounds” (@smitchell17). On Isaiah Likely: “Isaiah Likely signs a big free agent contract, ends up in New York with his old head coach, John Harbaugh” (@fantasypts). On Malachi Fields: “They also took a stance drafting Notre Dame standout Malachi Fields” (@smitchell17). On Darnell Mooney: “They raise the money just about \$750,000 and shoot this movie Obsession in 20 days” (@brettkollmann).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around Malik Nabers (board #31, ADP 36.5), with Jaxson Dart as the correlated ceiling pieces. Let the market overpay for Odell Beckham Jr., JuJu Smith-Schuster.

Risks & flags

Cam Skattebo — injury: Contested 4v3 backfield + fibula recovery vs Roman-fit bulls. 11/ 5 • Isaiah Likely — trap: Trap take Baker Mayfield instead (+18). 4.2

Tampa Bay Buccaneers (TB)

Bye W10 • Playoffs: W15 NO • W16 ATL • W17 LAR@TB (finals tail #1) • 1 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A balanced, average-pace attack and a middle scoring offense (2.24 implied TD/g, 19th). 1 alpha-ceiling player (p95≥33); best board asset is Emeka Egbuka at #36.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
36	Emeka Egbuka	WR	32.4	33	18.1%	86%	23.6% tgt
60	Bucky Irving	RB	59.5	32	17.7%	78%	11.9% tgt
91	Chris Godwin Jr.	WR	87.0	25	19.4%	63%	18.2% tgt
103	Kenneth Gainwell	RB	99.3	24	19.1%	58%	16.4% tgt
118	Baker Mayfield	QB	119.2	32	14.6%	56%	3.2 car/g
144	Jalen McMillan	WR	140.9	22	19.7%	57%	10.8% tgt
185	Sean Tucker	RB	181.4	6	20.1%	12%	5.3% tgt
191	Cade Otton	TE	187.6	18	20.7%	46%	17.4% tgt
204	Ted Hurst	WR	197.2	13	24.3%	33%	rookie/NA

Volume & script

58.8 plays/g (20th) • 31.0 pass att (23rd) • 52.8% pass rate (22nd) • 224.9 pass yds (21st) • 27.8 carries (10th) • 122.7 rush yds (12th) • 2.24 TD/g (19th)

A balanced script (52.8% pass) spreads opportunity without a strong structural lean either way. Scoring sits mid-pack (2.24 TD/g, 19th).

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

Emeka Egbuka 23.6% tgt / aDOT 12.3 / max 32.3 • Chris Godwin Jr. 18.2% tgt / aDOT 6.9 / max 26.8 • Cade Otton 17.4% tgt / aDOT 5.1 / max 22.4 • Bucky Irving 17.3 car/g, 3.0 rec/g, max 29.5

Emeka Egbuka is the focal point — a 23.6% target share in 2025 (fairly stable, cv 0.34), at a 12.3-yard aDOT (downfield routes), peaking at 32.3 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Chris Godwin Jr. (18.2%), Cade Otton (17.4%). In the backfield Bucky Irving profiled as a true workhorse (17.3 carries/g, and he caught 3.0 balls/g); ceiling week 29.5 DK. Small-sample caveat: Chris Godwin Jr. (9g), Jalen McMillan (4g) missed time, so the rates ride a partial season.

2026 outlook: what changes

Scheme watch — “One of the most exciting quotes of the offseason came a couple weeks ago when new Buccaneers offensive coordinator Zach Robinson said that Amika Igbuka is going to play the Z in his offense” (@benjaminsolak). Volume shift: Clay projects 31.0 pass att/g in 2026 vs 35.4 actual in 2025 (-4.4) — projected for lower pass volume / more run than 2025. Vacated opportunity: ~29.6% of the 2025 target volume turned over (meaningful turnover) — out: M.Evans (11.4%, gone), S.Shepard (9.9%, gone), R.White (8.3%, to WAS). In: Kenneth Gainwell (from PIT). Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): Emeka Egbuka 12.8/g proj vs 11.9/g in 2025 (+0.9, roughly steady); Bucky Irving 13.2/g proj vs 14.2/g in 2025 (-1.0, roughly steady); Chris Godwin Jr. 9.4/g proj vs 9.3/g in 2025 (+0.1, roughly steady); Kenneth Gainwell 10.0/g proj vs 12.8/g in 2025 (-2.8, projected to regress, joins from PIT).

Ceiling & upside

Emeka Egbuka p95 33 (18.1% spike)

1 players clear the alpha-ceiling bar, led by Emeka Egbuka (p95 33, hits a spike week 18.1% of the time). This is the currency that wins best ball — these are the weekly outcomes that drag a lineup into the 90th percentile. Highest-variance (boom/bust) of the group: Emeka Egbuka — exactly the volatility you want on a bench that only counts its best weeks.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: Emeka Egbuka (86%), Bucky Irving (78%), Chris Godwin Jr. (63%). Pure spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): Chris Godwin Jr., Kenneth Gainwell, Jalen McMillan — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Baker Mayfield + Emeka Egbuka / Chris Godwin Jr. — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r \approx 0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is LAR@TB — a top-tier blow-up game (tail rank #1); the natural bring-back is a LAR pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byes fall in Week 10, and the playoff run is W15 vs NO, W16 vs ATL.

Coachspeak & film

On the team: “One of the most exciting quotes of the offseason came a couple weeks ago when new Buccaneers offensive coordinator Zach Robinson said that Amika Igbuka is going to play the Z in his offense”. On Bucky Irving: “The Gainwell buzz + Bucky Irving injury fear is pushing him into a very comfortable range of drafts, behind Skatt and just ahead of TreVeyon/Montgomery” (@ffdataroma). On Baker Mayfield: “The Bucs, obviously, are a talented team with a quarterback in Baker Mayfield ready to get back into having playoff success” (@dhananizain). On Ted Hurst: “And just to watch the steps that they're taking from year one to year two, when it comes to Mac and Tez, and watching them help Ted Hurst out as well” (@dhananizain).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around Emeka Egbuka (board #36, ADP 32.4). Let the market overpay for Tez Johnson.

Risks & flags

Chris Godwin Jr. — age: Age / role-decline flag. 11

Green Bay Packers (GB)

Bye W11 • Playoffs: W15 MIA • W16 CHI • W17 GB@HOU (finals tail #10) • 1 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A balanced, average-pace attack and a middle scoring offense (2.47 implied TD/g, 12th). 1 alpha-ceiling player (p95≥33); best board asset is Josh Jacobs at #39.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
39	Josh Jacobs	RB	44.4	37	17.0%	88%	10.7% tgt
57	Christian Watson	WR	54.6	29	19.2%	75%	20.0% tgt
83	Tucker Kraft	TE	80.1	26	19.0%	77%	18.9% tgt
97	Jayden Reed	WR	89.9	26	18.4%	65%	17.3% tgt
109	Jordan Love	QB	111.1	32	14.9%	51%	3.0 car/g
112	Matthew Golden	WR	114.6	29	18.3%	76%	12.4% tgt
219	MarShawn Lloyd	RB	209.5	12	25.2%	37%	rookie/NA
247	Chris Brooks	RB	225.5	10	24.0%	30%	5.8% tgt
287	Luke Musgrave	TE	229.5	9	20.7%	10%	8.2% tgt

Volume & script

58.8 plays/g (19th) • 31.2 pass att (18th) • 53.1% pass rate (21st) • 234.9 pass yds (10th) • 27.6 carries (13th) • 118.7 rush yds (18th) • 2.47 TD/g (12th)

A balanced script (53.1% pass) spreads opportunity without a strong structural lean either way. Scoring sits mid-pack (2.47 TD/g, 12th).

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

Christian Watson 20.0% tgt / aDOT 17.2 / max 25.3 • Tucker Kraft 18.9% tgt / aDOT 4.6 / max 36.3 • Jayden Reed 17.3% tgt / aDOT 9.4 / max 15.7 • Josh Jacobs 15.8 car/g, 2.3 rec/g, max 32.0

Christian Watson is the focal point — a 20.0% target share in 2025 (fairly stable, cv 0.41), at a 17.2-yard aDOT (downfield routes), peaking at 25.3 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Tucker Kraft (18.9%), Jayden Reed (17.3%). In the backfield Josh Jacobs profiled as a true workhorse (15.8 carries/g, with a thin receiving role); ceiling week 32.0 DK. Small-sample caveat: Tucker Kraft (8g), Jayden Reed (6g) missed time, so the rates ride a partial season.

2026 outlook: what changes

Scheme watch — “He had gotten the job because he was the offensive coordinator with the Green Bay Packers for the previous three seasons” (@thepowerrank). Volume shift: Clay projects 31.2 pass att/g in 2026 vs 31.5 actual in 2025 (-0.3) — holding steady on pass volume. Vacated opportunity: ~28.6% of the 2025 target volume turned over (meaningful turnover) — out: R.Doubs (19.4%, to NE), D.Wicks (9.2%, to PHI). Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): Josh Jacobs 16.3/g proj vs 15.4/g in 2025 (+0.9, roughly steady); Christian Watson 10.9/g proj vs 13.5/g in 2025 (-2.6, projected to regress); Tucker Kraft 9.5/g proj vs 15.4/g in 2025 (-5.9, projected to regress); Jayden Reed 9.8/g proj vs 10.7/g in 2025 (-0.9, roughly steady).

Ceiling & upside

Josh Jacobs p95 37 (17.0% spike)

1 players clear the alpha-ceiling bar, led by Josh Jacobs (p95 37, hits a spike week 17.0% of the time). This is the currency that wins best ball — these are the weekly outcomes that drag a lineup into the 90th percentile.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: Josh Jacobs (88%), Tucker Kraft (77%), Matthew Golden (76%). Pure spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): Christian Watson, Tucker Kraft, Jayden Reed — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Jordan Love + Christian Watson / Matthew Golden — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r \approx 0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is GB@HOU — a mid-tier finals game (tail rank #10); the natural bring-back is a HOU pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byes fall in Week 11, and the playoff run is W15 vs MIA, W16 vs CHI.

Coachspeak & film

On the team: “Critically, in Green Bay, that offense was a little less oriented on getting the ball to the intermediate middle of the field for Jordan Love relative to some of the other quarterbacks who’ve played in other branches”. On Josh Jacobs: “Both 2024 Alexander Madison and 2023 Josh Jacobs had poor yards before contact per rush playing for the Raiders” (@benjaminsolak). On Jayden Reed: “I still want to draft Jaden Reed as wide receiver 41, but he would be roadblocked in that scenario” (@mattharmon_byb). On Matthew Golden: “And you look at Matthew Golden, his route participation in the heavy sets down at 43%” (@joshnorris).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around Josh Jacobs (board #39, ADP 44.4). Let the market overpay for Chris Brooks, Luke Musgrave.

Risks & flags

Josh Jacobs — risk: Booked at OTAs; personal-conduct investigation suspension possible. 11 • Christian Watson — contingency: Leveraged insurance: +11.1 pts if Josh Jacobs misses time. 9 • Tucker Kraft — injury: Knee (~10mo); TE4-6 case real / TE1 stretch. 11

Carolina Panthers (CAR)

Bye W5 • Playoffs: W15 CIN • W16 PIT • W17 CAR@SEA (finals tail #5) • 1 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A balanced, low-snap attack and a muted scoring offense (1.82 implied TD/g, 26th). 1 alpha-ceiling player (p95≥33); best board asset is Tetairoa McMillan at #41.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
41	Tetairoa McMillan	WR	42.1	36	16.4%	88%	25.3% tgt
75	Chuba Hubbard	RB	71.8	26	18.6%	64%	8.9% tgt
110	Jonathon Brooks	RB	106.5	22	19.8%	53%	rookie/NA
135	Jalen Coker	WR	132.0	23	18.6%	62%	17.2% tgt
143	Bryce Young	QB	148.9	25	9.3%	36%	3.4 car/g
232	Chris Brazzell II	WR	221.6	13	24.6%	28%	rookie/NA
258	Trevor Etienne	RB	225.9	7	20.4%	15%	10.1% tgt
296	Xavier Legette	WR	230.9	13	23.9%	37%	14.0% tgt
305	John Metchie III	WR	231.1				14.2% tgt

Volume & script

58.1 plays/g (30th) • 31.6 pass att (17th) • 54.4% pass rate (14th) • 213.8 pass yds (31st) • 26.5 carries (24th) • 111.7 rush yds (27th) • 1.82 TD/g (26th)

A balanced script (54.4% pass) spreads opportunity without a strong structural lean either way, but the deliberate pace (58.1 snaps/g, 30th) caps the raw opportunity to go around. The 26th-ranked scoring rate (1.82 TD/g) is the cap here — touchdown-dependent ceilings get harder to hit.

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

Tetairoa McMillan 25.3% tgt / aDOT 11.7 / max 36.0 • Jalen Coker 17.2% tgt / aDOT 10.1 / max 31.4 • John Metchie III 14.2% tgt / aDOT 5.6 / max 18.5 • Trevor Etienne 15.0 car/g, 2.3 rec/g, max 31.5

Tetairoa McMillan is the focal point — a 25.3% target share in 2025 (rock-steady, cv 0.32), at a 11.7-yard aDOT (all-levels routes), peaking at 36.0 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Jalen Coker (17.2%). In the backfield Trevor Etienne (2025 with JAX) profiled as a true workhorse (15.0 carries/g, with a thin receiving role); ceiling week 31.5 DK.

2026 outlook: what changes

Volume shift: Clay projects 31.6 pass att/g in 2026 vs 33.1 actual in 2025 (-1.5) — projected for lower pass volume / more run than 2025. Vacated opportunity: ~20.0% of the 2025 target volume turned over (meaningful turnover) — out: R.Dowdle (10.0%, to PIT), H.Renfrow (5.0%, gone), M.Evans (5.0%, gone). In: Trevor Etienne (from JAX); John Metchie III (from NYJ) • rookies: Jonathon Brooks. Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): Tetairoa McMillan 14.0/g proj vs 12.9/g in 2025 (+1.1, roughly steady); Chuba Hubbard 10.6/g proj vs 9.1/g in 2025 (+1.5, roughly steady); Jalen Coker 8.7/g proj vs 10.0/g in 2025 (-1.3, roughly steady); Bryce Young 14.9/g proj vs 15.1/g in 2025 (-0.2, roughly steady).

Ceiling & upside

Tetairoa McMillan p95 36 (16.4% spike)

1 players clear the alpha-ceiling bar, led by Tetairoa McMillan (p95 36, hits a spike week 16.4% of the time). This is the currency that wins best ball — these are the weekly outcomes that drag a lineup into the 90th percentile.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: Tetairoa McMillan (88%), Chuba Hubbard (64%), Jalen Coker (62%).

Pure spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): Chuba Hubbard, Jonathon Brooks, Jalen Coker — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Bryce Young + Tetairoa McMillan / Jalen Coker — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r \approx 0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is CAR@SEA — a top-tier blow-up game (tail rank #5); the natural bring-back is a SEA pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byes fall in Week 5, and the playoff run is W15 vs CIN, W16 vs PIT.

Coachspeak & film

On Chuba Hubbard: “7 early Fantasy Football takes/questions after firing off some best ball drafts: - Who is taking Chuba Hubbard in the 6th round?!” (@connorallennfl).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around Tetairoa McMillan (board #41, ADP 42.1). Let the market overpay for Chris Brazzell II, Trevor Etienne.

Risks & flags

No specific risk overlays on this group; the main risk is generic (price vs the field).

Chicago Bears (CHI)

Bye W10 · Playoffs: W15 BUF · W16 GB · W17 CHI@DET (finals tail #4) · 1 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A run-leaning, high-volume attack and a middle scoring offense (2.41 implied TD/g, 14th). 1 alpha-ceiling player (p95≥33); best board asset is Colston Loveland at #44.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
44	Colston Loveland	TE	39.7	30	17.6%	94%	18.0% tgt
45	Luther Burden III	WR	42.2	30	17.8%	80%	13.3% tgt
55	D'Andre Swift	RB	53.2	30	17.7%	76%	9.0% tgt
61	Rome Odunze	WR	56.6	32	17.9%	82%	22.3% tgt
64	Caleb Williams	QB	68.6	33	14.3%	64%	5.7% tgt
101	Kyle Monangai	RB	95.9	25	18.9%	60%	7.0% tgt
283	Zavion Thomas	WR	227.6	2	12.3%	1%	rookie/NA
298	Kalif Raymond	WR	231.1	13	22.5%	27%	7.5% tgt
303	Cole Kmet	TE	229.4	12	24.4%	21%	9.3% tgt

Volume & script

60.2 plays/g (4th) · 31.1 pass att (21st) · 51.6% pass rate (27th) · 224.8 pass yds (22nd) · 29.2 carries (4th) · 134.0 rush yds (4th) · 2.41 TD/g (14th)

A run-leaning script (51.6% pass vs 54% league) tilts value toward the backfield and compresses the passing pie, and the pace is real — 60.2 snaps/g (4th) manufactures extra possessions for everyone. Scoring sits mid-pack (2.41 TD/g, 14th).

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

Rome Odunze 22.3% tgt / aDOT 14.3 / max 34.8 · Colston Loveland 18.0% tgt / aDOT 9.7 / max 32.8 · Luther Burden III 13.3% tgt / aDOT 8.1 / max 30.8 · D'Andre Swift 14.2 car/g, 2.0 rec/g, max 28.5

Rome Odunze is the focal point — a 22.3% target share in 2025 (rock-steady, cv 0.32), at a 14.3-yard aDOT (downfield routes), peaking at 34.8 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Colston Loveland (18.0%). In the backfield D'Andre Swift profiled as the lead of a rotation (14.2 carries/g, with a thin receiving role); ceiling week 28.5 DK. Small-sample caveat: Jahdae Walker (3g) missed time, so the rates ride a partial season.

2026 outlook: what changes

Volume shift: Clay projects 31.1 pass att/g in 2026 vs 36.5 actual in 2025 (-5.4) — projected for lower pass volume / more run than 2025. Vacated opportunity: ~27.2% of the 2025 target volume turned over (meaningful turnover) — out: D.Moore (16.0%, gone), O.Zaccheaus (11.2%, to ATL). In: Kalif Raymond (from DET). Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): Colston Loveland 12.1/g proj vs 11.2/g in 2025 (+0.9, roughly steady); Luther Burden III 12.0/g proj vs 8.6/g in 2025 (+3.4, trending up); D'Andre Swift 12.4/g proj vs 14.6/g in 2025 (-2.2, projected to regress); Rome Odunze 12.4/g proj vs 11.7/g in 2025 (+0.7, roughly steady).

Ceiling & upside

Caleb Williams p95 33 (14.3% spike)

1 players clear the alpha-ceiling bar, led by Caleb Williams (p95 33, hits a spike week 14.3% of the time). This is the currency that wins best ball — these are the weekly outcomes that drag a lineup into the 90th percentile.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: Colston Loveland (94%), Rome Odunze (82%), Luther Burden III (80%). Pure spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): Kyle Monangai, Kalif Raymond, Cole Kmet — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Caleb Williams + Rome Odunze / Colston Loveland — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r \approx 0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is CHI@DET — a top-tier blow-up game (tail rank #4); the natural bring-back is a DET pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byes fall in Week 10, and the playoff run is W15 vs BUF, W16 vs GB.

Coachspeak & film

On the team: “I think when you see the way that he moves, you can envision all kinds of possibilities in this Bears offense, in the Bears special teams”. On Colston Loveland: “Ran for some run after catch in Colston Loveland” (@dhananizain). On Luther Burden III: “Like I'm the person who would people would think of it's like not being excited enough about Luther burden but like Luther burden was literally my highest drafted player last year” (@patkerrane). On D'Andre Swift: “-Death, taxes, D'Andre Swift beating ADP -Luther Burden -Round 4 Colston Loveland?!?” (@ihartitz).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around Caleb Williams (board #64, ADP 68.6). Let the market overpay for Zavion Thomas, Kalif Raymond.

Risks & flags

Colston Loveland — contingency: Leveraged insurance: +10.8 pts if Rome Odunze misses time. 9 • Luther Burden III — contingency: Leveraged insurance: +12.9 pts if Rome Odunze misses time. 9 • Rome Odunze — injury: Foot “permanent damage” per beat; missed 5+ games 2025. 11 • Caleb Williams — trap: Trap take Parker Washington instead (+18). 4.2

Washington Commanders (WAS)

Bye W7 • Playoffs: W15 ATL • W16 MIN • W17 JAX@WAS (finals tail #12) • 1 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A run-leaning, average-pace attack and a middle scoring offense (2.29 implied TD/g, 17th). 1 alpha-ceiling player (p95≥33); best board asset is Terry McLaurin at #49.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
49	Terry McLaurin	WR	46.5	32	17.5%	87%	23.1% tgt
65	Jayden Daniels	QB	69.2	36	13.0%	90%	8.4 car/g
124	Rachaad White	RB	122.5	24	18.9%	62%	8.2% tgt
130	Jacory Croskey-Merritt	RB	121.8	22	19.0%	55%	rookie/NA
151	Chig Okonkwo	TE	145.4				15.0% tgt
164	Antonio Williams	WR	159.3	19	20.3%	53%	rookie/NA
201	Kaytron Allen	RB	195.8	3	17.4%	3%	rookie/NA
270	Luke McCaffrey	WR	229.0			1%	9.0% tgt
271	Treylon Burks	WR	231.9	10	21.7%	18%	12.4% tgt

Volume & script

58.7 plays/g (21st) • 30.6 pass att (25th) • 52.1% pass rate (25th) • 226.7 pass yds (19th) • 28.1 carries (8th) • 126.8 rush yds (6th) • 2.29 TD/g (17th)

A run-leaning script (52.1% pass vs 54% league) tilts value toward the backfield and compresses the passing pie. Scoring sits mid-pack (2.29 TD/g, 17th).

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

Terry McLaurin 23.1% tgt / aDOT 14.0 / max 22.6 • Chig Okonkwo 15.0% tgt / aDOT 4.6 / max 16.4 • Treylon Burks 12.4% tgt / aDOT 13.5 / max 8.8 • Rachaad White 7.8 car/g, 2.4 rec/g, max 23.1

Terry McLaurin is the focal point — a 23.1% target share in 2025 (rock-steady, cv 0.29), at a 14.0-yard aDOT (downfield routes), peaking at 22.6 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Chig Okonkwo (15.0%). In the backfield Rachaad White (2025 with TB) profiled as a committee back (7.8 carries/g, with a thin receiving role); ceiling week 23.1 DK. Small-sample caveat: Jayden Daniels (7g), Luke McCaffrey (7g) missed time, so the rates ride a partial season.

2026 outlook: what changes

Volume shift: Clay projects 30.6 pass att/g in 2026 vs 30.0 actual in 2025 (+0.6) — holding steady on pass volume. Vacated opportunity: ~59.5% of the 2025 target volume turned over (major turnover) — out: D.Samuel (22.9%, to FA), Z.Ertz (16.7%, to FA), J.McNichols (7.3%, gone), J.Lane (7.3%, to BAL). In: Rachaad White (from TB); Chig Okonkwo (from TEN); Dyami Brown (from JAX) • rookies: Jacory Croskey-Merritt, Antonio Williams. Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): Terry McLaurin 13.0/g proj vs 11.4/g in 2025 (+1.6, roughly steady); Jayden Daniels 19.4/g proj vs 16.8/g in 2025 (+2.6, trending up); Rachaad White 10.3/g proj vs 8.4/g in 2025 (+1.9, roughly steady, joins from TB); Luke McCaffrey 0.0/g proj vs 7.0/g in 2025 (-7.0, projected to regress).

Ceiling & upside

Jayden Daniels p95 36 (13.0% spike)

1 players clear the alpha-ceiling bar, led by Jayden Daniels (p95 36, hits a spike week 13.0% of the time). This is the currency that wins best ball — these are the weekly outcomes that drag a lineup into the 90th percentile.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: Jayden Daniels (90%), Terry McLaurin (87%), Rachaad White (62%). Pure spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): Rachaad White, Jacory Croskey-Merritt, Antonio Williams — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Jayden Daniels + Terry McLaurin / Antonio Williams — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r \approx 0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is JAX@WAS — a mid-tier finals game (tail rank #12); the natural bring-back is a JAX pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byes fall in Week 7, and the playoff run is W15 vs ATL, W16 vs MIN.

Coachspeak & film

On the team: “After he came back from injury, at which point Parker Washington had established himself in the offense, Jacoby Myers had been acquired from the Raiders, he averaged 17.5 area yards per target”. On Terry McLaurin: “I’m going to have Terry McLaurin way ahead of where he’s being drafted and ranked” (@joshnorris).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around Jayden Daniels (board #65, ADP 69.2). Let the market overpay for Luke McCaffrey, Treyton Burks.

Risks & flags

Terry McLaurin — age: Age / role-decline flag. 11

Denver Broncos (DEN)

Bye W10 • Playoffs: W15 LV • W16 BUF • W17 DEN@NE (finals tail #6) • 1 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A pass-first, average-pace attack and a middle scoring offense (2.47 implied TD/g, 13th). 1 alpha-ceiling player (p95≥33); best board asset is Jaylen Waddle at #50.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
50	Jaylen Waddle	WR	48.5	33	18.1%	83%	23.2% tgt
84	Courtland Sutton	WR	83.1	31	18.3%	81%	20.9% tgt
87	RJ Harvey	RB	79.9	24	19.0%	59%	11.0% tgt
111	Bo Nix	QB	111.6	30	9.3%	74%	2.8% tgt
115	J.K. Dobbins	RB	110.8	25	18.9%	63%	4.5% tgt
174	Jonah Coleman	RB	168.3	7	20.5%	14%	rookie/NA
224	Evan Engram	TE	223.2	18	20.2%	44%	13.3% tgt
235	Pat Bryant	WR	225.0	14	23.0%	38%	10.9% tgt
242	Troy Franklin	WR	223.0	11	23.1%	21%	18.5% tgt

Volume & script

59.4 plays/g (12th) • 33.2 pass att (9th) • 55.9% pass rate (7th) • 227.7 pass yds (18th) • 26.2 carries (26th) • 116.8 rush yds (20th) • 2.47 TD/g (13th)

This is a genuinely pass-first script — 55.9% pass rate against a 54% league mean — so the receiving corps, not the backfield, is where the fantasy points concentrate. Scoring sits mid-pack (2.47 TD/g, 13th).

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

Jaylen Waddle 23.2% tgt / aDOT 13.1 / max 26.0 • Courtland Sutton 20.9% tgt / aDOT 12.2 / max 27.3 • Troy Franklin 18.5% tgt / aDOT 12.3 / max 26.9 • J.K. Dobbins 15.3 car/g, 1.1 rec/g, max 17.1

Jaylen Waddle (2025 with MIA) is the focal point — a 23.2% target share in 2025 (fairly stable, cv 0.37), at a 13.1-yard aDOT (downfield routes), peaking at 26.0 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Courtland Sutton (20.9%), Troy Franklin (18.5%). In the backfield J.K. Dobbins profiled as a true workhorse (15.3 carries/g, with a thin receiving role); ceiling week 17.1 DK.

2026 outlook: what changes

Volume shift: Clay projects 33.2 pass att/g in 2026 vs 37.9 actual in 2025 (-4.7) — projected for lower pass volume / more run than 2025. Vacated opportunity: ~9.8% of the 2025 target volume turned over (a largely intact target tree) — out: L.Humphrey (4.9%, gone), T.Badie (4.9%, gone). In: Jaylen Waddle (from MIA) • rookies: Jonah Coleman. Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): Jaylen Waddle 12.5/g proj vs 12.3/g in 2025 (+0.2, roughly steady, joins from MIA); Courtland Sutton 12.1/g proj vs 12.8/g in 2025 (-0.7, roughly steady); RJ Harvey 10.0/g proj vs 12.1/g in 2025 (-2.1, projected to regress); Bo Nix 18.1/g proj vs 19.2/g in 2025 (-1.1, roughly steady).

Ceiling & upside

Jaylen Waddle p95 33 (18.1% spike)

1 players clear the alpha-ceiling bar, led by Jaylen Waddle (p95 33, hits a spike week 18.1% of the time). This is the currency that wins best ball — these are the weekly outcomes that drag a lineup into the 90th percentile. Highest-variance (boom/bust) of the group: Jaylen Waddle — exactly the volatility you want on a bench that only counts its best weeks.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: Jaylen Waddle (83%), Courtland Sutton (81%), Bo Nix (74%). Pure spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): RJ Harvey, J.K. Dobbins, Jonah Coleman — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Bo Nix + Jaylen Waddle / Courtland Sutton — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r=0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is DEN@NE — a top-tier blow-up game (tail rank #6); the natural bring-back is a NE pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byses fall in Week 10, and the playoff run is W15 vs LV, W16 vs BUF.

Coachspeak & film

On the team: “A lot of volume last week and that trend continued here this week as the Broncos look to not only increase his usage but also his production this season after he played a career low in snaps in 2025”. On Courtland Sutton: “Courtland Sutton has been facing zero target comp the last 2 years in a much better offense, and he still managed to fade out for parts of 2025” (@ffdataroma). On RJ Harvey: “But I’m probably going to be wrong because my guess is Harvey is going to be the third down back” (@dhananizain). On Bo Nix: “He is a great personality, a guy that doesn’t have the extra ego, and he’s going to gel well with Bo Nix once he’s healthy and getting the flow” (@dhananizain).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around Jaylen Waddle (board #50, ADP 48.5). Let the market overpay for Pat Bryant, Troy Franklin.

Risks & flags

Bo Nix — trap: Trap take Kyler Murray instead (+16). 4.2 • structural: a pass-first, low-carry script makes the backfield a committee/touchdown-variance bet

Cleveland Browns (CLE)

Bye W11 • Playoffs: W15 NYG • W16 BAL • W17 CLE@IND (finals tail #15) • 0 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A balanced, average-pace attack and a muted scoring offense (1.47 implied TD/g, 31st). 0 alpha-ceiling players (p95≥33); best board asset is Quinshon Judkins at #56.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
56	Quinshon Judkins	RB	54.4	32	17.5%	79%	9.6% tgt
96	Harold Fannin Jr.	TE	86.6	27	17.7%	88%	21.9% tgt
131	KC Concepcion	WR	125.7	25	18.6%	63%	rookie/NA
166	Denzel Boston	WR	166.9	22	19.4%	58%	rookie/NA
177	Jerry Jeudy	WR	177.8	23	18.7%	60%	20.5% tgt
178	Dylan Sampson	RB	170.9	14	21.7%	42%	9.9% tgt
206	Deshaun Watson	QB	211.1	15	14.7%	23%	rookie/NA
225	Shedeur Sanders	QB	216.5			15%	2.8 car/g
317	Isaiah Bond	WR	227.6	5	17.0%	5%	9.9% tgt

Volume & script

59.1 plays/g (15th) • 32.0 pass att (15th) • 54.1% pass rate (16th) • 215.5 pass yds (30th) • 27.1 carries (16th) • 113.9 rush yds (24th) • 1.47 TD/g (31st)

A balanced script (54.1% pass) spreads opportunity without a strong structural lean either way. The 31st-ranked scoring rate (1.47 TD/g) is the cap here — touchdown-dependent ceilings get harder to hit.

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

Harold Fannin Jr. 21.9% tgt / aDOT 6.0 / max 28.4 • Jerry Jeudy 20.5% tgt / aDOT 12.2 / max 19.8 • Cedric Tillman 10.5% tgt / aDOT 11.9 / max 16.2 • Quinshon Judkins 16.5 car/g, 1.9 rec/g, max 26.4

Harold Fannin Jr. is the focal point — a 21.9% target share in 2025 (fairly stable, cv 0.42), at a 6.0-yard aDOT (short-area routes), peaking at 28.4 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Jerry Jeudy (20.5%). In the backfield Quinshon Judkins profiled as a true workhorse (16.5 carries/g, with a thin receiving role); ceiling week 26.4 DK. Small-sample caveat: Shedeur Sanders (8g) missed time, so the rates ride a partial season.

2026 outlook: what changes

Volume shift: Clay projects 32.0 pass att/g in 2026 vs 35.9 actual in 2025 (-3.9) — projected for lower pass volume / more run than 2025. Vacated opportunity: ~15.2% of the 2025 target volume turned over (a largely intact target tree) — out: D.Njoku (9.1%, to LAC), J.Ford (6.1%, gone). In: no veteran additions of note • rookies: KC Concepcion, Denzel Boston. Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): Quinshon Judkins 13.3/g proj vs 12.2/g in 2025 (+1.1, roughly steady); Harold Fannin Jr. 10.9/g proj vs 11.9/g in 2025 (-1.0, roughly steady); Jerry Jeudy 8.2/g proj vs 7.2/g in 2025 (+1.0, roughly steady); Dylan Sampson 5.0/g proj vs 5.9/g in 2025 (-0.9, roughly steady).

Ceiling & upside

No alpha-ceiling (p95≥33) bats here — the top spike is Quinshon Judkins at p95 32 (17.5% spike weeks). In a top-2-advance pod this is a ceiling-light room you lean on for value, not for the league-winning week.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: Harold Fannin Jr. (88%), Quinshon Judkins (79%), KC Concepcion (63%). Pure spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): KC Concepcion, Denzel Boston, Jerry Jeudy — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Deshaun Watson + Harold Fannin Jr. / KC Concepcion — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r \approx 0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is CLE@IND — a lower-variance finals game (tail rank #15); the natural bring-back is a IND pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byes fall in Week 11, and the playoff run is W15 vs NYG, W16 vs BAL.

Coachspeak & film

On the team: “Cleveland gave away Miles Garrett, who is exiting his prime, and in return they got Jared Verse, a defensive player who's entering his prime and a bunch of draft picks”. On Quinshon Judkins: “When I was talking about Quincy Judkins playing in control and his feet being underneath him and playing more athletic than what his, his numbers would suggest, the inverse is true for Toon” (@joshnorris). On Harold Fannin Jr.: “One guy that I am a huge fan of, who I think is going to be very talented, is Fannin Jr” (@clevta). On KC Concepcion: “WR24 - KC Concepcion (WR30 ADP) + Really strong prospect with fantasy friendly skillset (YAC, separator) and clear path to strong volume, offense live to be much improved in 2027 w/ new QB” (@ffdataroma).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around Quinshon Judkins (board #56, ADP 54.4). Let the market overpay for Isaiah Bond, Cedric Tillman.

Risks & flags

Quinshon Judkins — injury: Dislocated ankle + fractured fibula 12/21/25; recovery concern. 11

Jacksonville Jaguars (JAX)

Bye W7 • Playoffs: W15 HOU • W16 DAL • W17 JAX@WAS (finals tail #12) • 1 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A pass-first, average-pace attack and a middle scoring offense (2.35 implied TD/g, 16th). 1 alpha-ceiling player (p95≥33); best board asset is Bhayshul Tuten at #58.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
58	Bhayshul Tuten	RB	61.7	28	18.1%	74%	4.4% tgt
70	Parker Washington	WR	63.8	28	18.5%	73%	20.9% tgt
72	Brian Thomas Jr.	WR	70.1	27	19.0%	71%	18.4% tgt
79	Trevor Lawrence	QB	86.7	35	14.5%	77%	4.9 car/g
105	Jakobi Meyers	WR	102.8	28	18.3%	72%	22.2% tgt
140	Chris Rodriguez Jr.	RB	130.2	12	23.3%	38%	4.0% tgt
154	Brenton Strange	TE	151.9	22	19.9%	63%	15.6% tgt
160	Travis Hunter	WR	154.4	19	20.9%	52%	17.4% tgt
291	LeQuint Allen Jr.	RB	229.6	10	22.0%	27%	3.7% tgt

Volume & script

58.7 plays/g (21st) • 32.9 pass att (10th) • 56.1% pass rate (6th) • 231.1 pass yds (14th) • 25.8 carries (29th) • 111.5 rush yds (28th) • 2.35 TD/g (16th)

This is a genuinely pass-first script — 56.1% pass rate against a 54% league mean — so the receiving corps, not the backfield, is where the fantasy points concentrate. Scoring sits mid-pack (2.35 TD/g, 16th).

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

Jakobi Meyers 22.2% tgt / aDOT 9.2 / max 21.3 • Parker Washington 20.9% tgt / aDOT 12.2 / max 29.5 • Brian Thomas Jr. 18.4% tgt / aDOT 14.4 / max 23.0 • J'Mari Taylor 19.1 car/g, 2.7 rec/g, max 52.6

Jakobi Meyers is the focal point — a 22.2% target share in 2025 (rock-steady, cv 0.31), at a 9.2-yard aDOT (all-levels routes), peaking at 21.3 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Parker Washington (20.9%), Brian Thomas Jr. (18.4%). In the backfield J'Mari Taylor (2025 with IND) profiled as a true workhorse (19.1 carries/g, with a thin receiving role); ceiling week 52.6 DK. Small-sample caveat: Travis Hunter (7g) missed time, so the rates ride a partial season.

2026 outlook: what changes

Volume shift: Clay projects 32.9 pass att/g in 2026 vs 35.4 actual in 2025 (-2.5) — projected for lower pass volume / more run than 2025. Vacated opportunity: ~15.0% of the 2025 target volume turned over (a largely intact target tree) — out: T.Etienne (9.1%, to CAR), D.Brown (5.9%, to WAS). In: Chris Rodriguez Jr. (from WAS); J'Mari Taylor (from IND). Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): Bhayshul Tuten 12.1/g proj vs 5.9/g in 2025 (+6.2, trending up); Parker Washington 10.8/g proj vs 12.8/g in 2025 (-2.0, projected to regress); Brian Thomas Jr. 10.3/g proj vs 9.9/g in 2025 (+0.4, roughly steady); Trevor Lawrence 18.1/g proj vs 20.8/g in 2025 (-2.7, projected to regress).

Ceiling & upside

Trevor Lawrence p95 35 (14.5% spike)

1 players clear the alpha-ceiling bar, led by Trevor Lawrence (p95 35, hits a spike week 14.5% of the time). This is the currency that wins best ball — these are the weekly outcomes that drag a lineup into the 90th percentile.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: Trevor Lawrence (77%), Bhayshul Tuten (74%), Parker Washington (73%). Pure spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): Bhayshul Tuten, Parker Washington, Brian Thomas Jr. — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Trevor Lawrence + Parker Washington / Jakobi Meyers — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r \approx 0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is JAX@WAS — a mid-tier finals game (tail rank #12); the natural bring-back is a WAS pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byes fall in Week 7, and the playoff run is W15 vs HOU, W16 vs DAL.

Coachspeak & film

On the team: “But he did get to a decent place in the offense last season, especially when the Jaguars stopped trying to use him as a three-level all-around threat and primarily used him as a field-stretching downfield target”. On Bhayshul Tuten: “Member when Bhayshul Tuten entered his first playoff game and ripped off gains of 20, 14, and 13 on three-straight runs?” (@jagibbs_23). On Parker Washington: “If we see a tweet from Dave, I’m on a fantasy points show right now and talking about Parker Washington as the worst pick in round six of fantasy drafts” (@fantasypts). On Trevor Lawrence: “They felt like him and Trevor Lawrence didn’t necessarily have the chemistry there in the deep game early on in the season” (@dhananizain).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around Trevor Lawrence (board #79, ADP 86.7). Let the market overpay for LeQuint Allen Jr., Tanner Koziol.

Risks & flags

Bhayshul Tuten — trap: Trap take Rome Odunze instead (+15). 4.2 • Jakobi Meyers — trap: Trap take Jaxon Dart instead (+15). 4.2 • structural: a pass-first, low-carry script makes the backfield a committee/touchdown-variance bet

Tennessee Titans (TEN)

Bye W9 • Playoffs: W15 IND • W16 LV • W17 PIT@TEN (finals tail #13) • 0 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A pass-first, low-snap attack and a muted scoring offense (1.71 implied TD/g, 30th). 0 alpha-ceiling players (p95≥33); best board asset is Carnell Tate at #62.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
62	Carnell Tate	WR	62.1	32	17.5%	84%	rookie/NA
81	Tony Pollard	RB	77.6	27	18.1%	69%	8.6% tgt
113	Wan'Dale Robinson	WR	106.7	27	18.1%	70%	30.3% tgt
141	Cam Ward	QB	136.6				2.3 car/g
162	Tyjae Spears	RB	159.9	22	19.5%	57%	13.3% tgt
183	Gunnar Helm	TE	183.1	21	20.8%	58%	10.7% tgt
187	Calvin Ridley	WR	190.9	24	19.3%	61%	16.8% tgt
193	Nick Singleton	RB	186.0				rookie/NA
304	Chimere Dike	WR	229.2	7	21.0%	12%	14.8% tgt

Volume & script

58.2 plays/g (28th) • 32.8 pass att (11th) • 56.4% pass rate (3rd) • 220.8 pass yds (27th) • 25.4 carries (30th) • 110.2 rush yds (29th) • 1.71 TD/g (30th)

This is a genuinely pass-first script — 56.4% pass rate against a 54% league mean — so the receiving corps, not the backfield, is where the fantasy points concentrate, but the deliberate pace (58.2 snaps/g, 28th) caps the raw opportunity to go around. The 30th-ranked scoring rate (1.71 TD/g) is the cap here — touchdown-dependent ceilings get harder to hit.

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

Wan'Dale Robinson 30.3% tgt / aDOT 8.4 / max 33.6 • Elic Ayomanor 18.5% tgt / aDOT 12.7 / max 15.6 • Calvin Ridley 16.8% tgt / aDOT 12.6 / max 20.1 • Tony Pollard 14.2 car/g, 1.9 rec/g, max 31.1

Wan'Dale Robinson (2025 with NYG) is the focal point — a 30.3% target share in 2025 (rock-steady, cv 0.33), at a 8.4-yard aDOT (all-levels routes), peaking at 33.6 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Elic Ayomanor (18.5%), Calvin Ridley (16.8%). In the backfield Tony Pollard profiled as the lead of a rotation (14.2 carries/g, with a thin receiving role); ceiling week 31.1 DK. Small-sample caveat: Calvin Ridley (7g) missed time, so the rates ride a partial season.

2026 outlook: what changes

Volume shift: Clay projects 32.8 pass att/g in 2026 vs 36.8 actual in 2025 (-4.0) — projected for lower pass volume / more run than 2025. Vacated opportunity: ~25.7% of the 2025 target volume turned over (meaningful turnover) — out: C.Okonkwo (15.5%, to WAS), V.Jefferson (10.2%, gone). In: Wan'Dale Robinson (from NYG) • rookies: Carnell Tate, Nick Singleton. Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): Tony Pollard 11.3/g proj vs 11.6/g in 2025 (-0.3, roughly steady); Wan'Dale Robinson 10.3/g proj vs 14.2/g in 2025 (-3.9, projected to regress, joins from NYG); Tyjae Spears 9.1/g proj vs 8.6/g in 2025 (+0.5, roughly steady); Gunnar Helm 7.4/g proj vs 5.7/g in 2025 (+1.7, roughly steady).

Ceiling & upside

No alpha-ceiling (p95≥33) bats here — the top spike is Carnell Tate at p95 32 (17.5% spike weeks). In a top-2-advance pod this is a ceiling-light room you lean on for value, not for the league-winning week.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: Carnell Tate (84%), Wan'Dale Robinson (70%), Tony Pollard (69%). Pure spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): Tony Pollard, Wan'Dale Robinson, Tyjae Spears — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Cam Ward + Carnell Tate / Wan'Dale Robinson — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r=0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is PIT@TEN — a lower-variance finals game (tail rank #13); the natural bring-back is a PIT pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byes fall in Week 9, and the playoff run is W15 vs IND, W16 vs LV.

CoachSpeak & film

On the team: “I think, like you said, the ceiling is pretty low here, especially in the Titans offense”. On Cam Ward: “Like, what if Cam Ward plays, like, the first overall pick like he was last year?” (@joshnorris). On Tyjae Spears: “We talk about our defense being the tip of the spear of the team” (@syedschemes). On Calvin Ridley: “Here they are going to double him with a Fonga right here and Riley Moss” (@dhananizain).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around Carnell Tate (board #62, ADP 62.1). Let the market overpay for Chimere Dike, Elic Ayomanor.

Risks & flags

Cam Ward — trap: Trap take Tyrone Tracy Jr. instead (+20). 4.2 • structural: a pass-first, low-carry script makes the backfield a committee/touchdown-variance bet

Pittsburgh Steelers (PIT)

Bye W9 · Playoffs: W15 BAL · W16 CAR · W17 PIT@TEN (finals tail #13) · 0 alpha-ceiling player(s)

Snapshot. A pass-first, average-pace attack and a muted scoring offense (1.76 implied TD/g, 27th). 0 alpha-ceiling players (p95≥33); best board asset is DK Metcalf at #77.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
77	DK Metcalf	WR	74.3	30	18.1%	78%	21.9% tgt
85	Jaylen Warren	RB	81.8	27	18.9%	66%	10.4% tgt
92	Rico Dowdle	RB	90.8	27	18.7%	65%	11.3% tgt
98	Michael Pittman Jr.	WR	99.3	29	17.5%	78%	21.0% tgt
158	Aaron Rodgers	QB	161.2	28	15.3%	31%	3.0% tgt
192	Germie Bernard	WR	187.5	21	20.1%	56%	rookie/NA
194	Pat Freiermuth	TE	197.7	23	20.0%	62%	11.1% tgt
256	Darnell Washington	TE	227.2	14	23.6%	37%	11.4% tgt
326	Eli Heidenreich	WR	227.2				rookie/NA

Volume & script

59.6 plays/g (11th) · 33.5 pass att (6th) · 56.2% pass rate (5th) · 221.4 pass yds (26th) · 26.1 carries (28th) · 112.9 rush yds (26th) · 1.76 TD/g (27th)

This is a genuinely pass-first script — 56.2% pass rate against a 54% league mean — so the receiving corps, not the backfield, is where the fantasy points concentrate. The 27th-ranked scoring rate (1.76 TD/g) is the cap here — touchdown-dependent ceilings get harder to hit.

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

DK Metcalf 21.9% tgt / aDOT 10.6 / max 26.6 · Michael Pittman Jr. 21.0% tgt / aDOT 8.0 / max 23.5 · Darnell Washington 11.4% tgt / aDOT 5.5 / max 10.7 · Rico Dowdle 13.4 car/g, 2.2 rec/g, max 36.9

DK Metcalf is the focal point — a 21.9% target share in 2025 (rock-steady, cv 0.31), at a 10.6-yard aDOT (all-levels routes), peaking at 26.6 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Michael Pittman Jr. (21.0%). In the backfield Rico Dowdle (2025 with CAR) profiled as the lead of a rotation (13.4 carries/g, with a thin receiving role); ceiling week 36.9 DK. Small-sample caveat: Roman Wilson (9g) missed time, so the rates ride a partial season.

2026 outlook: what changes

Volume shift: Clay projects 33.5 pass att/g in 2026 vs 34.5 actual in 2025 (-1.0) — holding steady on pass volume. Vacated opportunity: ~44.8% of the 2025 target volume turned over (major turnover) — out: K.Gainwell (16.7%, to TB), C.Austin (11.2%, to NYG), J.Smith (10.7%, gone), M.Valdes-Scantling (6.2%, gone). In: Rico Dowdle (from CAR); Michael Pittman Jr. (from IND) · rookies: Germie Bernard. Player deltas (2025 actual → 2026 projection): DK Metcalf 11.5/g proj vs 12.5/g in 2025 (-1.0, roughly steady); Jaylen Warren 11.0/g proj vs 13.5/g in 2025 (-2.5, projected to regress); Rico Dowdle 10.8/g proj vs 12.7/g in 2025 (-1.9, roughly steady, joins from CAR); Michael Pittman Jr. 11.6/g proj vs 12.0/g in 2025 (-0.4, roughly steady, joins from IND).

Ceiling & upside

No alpha-ceiling (p95≥33) bats here — the top spike is DK Metcalf at p95 30 (18.1% spike weeks). In a top-2-advance pod this is a ceiling-light room you lean on for value, not for the league-winning week.

Regular-season value (advancement)

Advancement is the binding gate in a 12-team/top-2 pod — the players who actually bank points week to week. Best regular-season equity: DK Metcalf (78%), Michael Pittman Jr. (78%), Jaylen Warren (66%).

Pure spike profiles (big ceiling, thinner advancement floor): DK Metcalf, Jaylen Warren, Rico Dowdle — useful as upside dart-throws, not as the backbone of the grind.

Stacking & the Week 17 finals

The stack spine is Aaron Rodgers + DK Metcalf / Michael Pittman Jr. — QB-WR1 correlation runs $r=0.35$ league-wide, so pairing them converts one good game script into two scoring lineups. The Week 17 finals slot is PIT@TEN — a lower-variance finals game (tail rank #13); the natural bring-back is a TEN pass-catcher to play both sides of that game. Byes fall in Week 9, and the playoff run is W15 vs BAL, W16 vs CAR.

CoachSpeak & film

On Rico Dowdle: “He could be a guy that defines this offense when they were at their best Rico Dowdle was playing really well” (@adamlevitan). On Michael Pittman Jr.: “There a more triple condom pick on the best ball board than Michael Pittman Jr?” (@smitchell17). On Aaron Rodgers: “They have two third-round picks in 2025 in Caleb Rogers and Charles Grant, and then a 2026 third-rounder in Trey Zoon III” (@benjaminsolak).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around DK Metcalf (board #77, ADP 74.3). Let the market overpay for Darnell Washington, Eli Heidenreich.

Risks & flags

structural: a pass-first, low-carry script makes the backfield a committee/touchdown-variance bet

FA (FA)

Snapshot. FA are an unsigned-player bucket in this snapshot — landing spot drives everything, so treat the ceiling numbers below as talent, not opportunity.

Brd	Player	Pos	ADP	Ceil	Spike	Adv	2025 use
139	Stefon Diggs	WR	138.1				21.4% tgt
172	Deebo Samuel Sr.	WR	180.8				25.5% tgt
189	Tyreek Hill	WR	178.7				rookie/NA
240	Nick Chubb	RB	226.3				5.1% tgt
244	Darren Waller	TE	229.1				16.6% tgt
246	Kareem Hunt	RB	225.6				5.3% tgt
250	Austin Ekeler	RB	230.2				rookie/NA
262	DeAndre Hopkins	WR	226.6				9.8% tgt
279	Zach Ertz	TE	228.3				19.4% tgt

Usage & opportunity (2025 PBP)

Deebo Samuel Sr. 25.5% tgt / aDOT 5.3 / max 23.6 · Stefon Diggs 21.4% tgt / aDOT 8.2 / max 27.6 · Zach Ertz 19.4% tgt / aDOT 9.0 / max 23.6 · Kareem Hunt 9.6 car/g, 1.1 rec/g, max 24.0

Deebo Samuel Sr. (2025 with WAS) is the focal point — a 25.5% target share in 2025 (rock-steady, cv 0.32), at a 5.3-yard aDOT (short-area routes), peaking at 23.6 DK in his best week. Secondary volume goes to Stefon Diggs (21.4%), Zach Ertz (19.4%). In the backfield Kareem Hunt (2025 with KC) profiled as a committee back (9.6 carries/g, with a thin receiving role); ceiling week 24.0 DK. Small-sample caveat: Darren Waller (8g) missed time, so the rates ride a partial season.

Ceiling & upside

No alpha-ceiling (p95≥33) bats here — the top spike is Stefon Diggs at p95 None (None% spike weeks). In a top-2-advance pod this is a ceiling-light room you lean on for value, not for the league-winning week.

Coachspeak & film

On Stefon Diggs: “You draft no Wide Receivers in best ball and then finish the draft with: Stefon Diggs Travis Hunter Brandon Aiyuk Tank Dell Deebo Samuel Tyreek Hill And 2 other guys” (@chessliam). On Deebo Samuel Sr.: “You draft no Wide Receivers in best ball and then finish the draft with: Stefon Diggs Travis Hunter Brandon Aiyuk Tank Dell Deebo Samuel Tyreek Hill And 2 other guys” (@chessliam). On Tyreek Hill: “You draft no Wide Receivers in best ball and then finish the draft with: Stefon Diggs Travis Hunter Brandon Aiyuk Tank Dell Deebo Samuel Tyreek Hill And 2 other guys” (@chessliam). On Nick Chubb: “I learned how to be egoless from Nick Chubb” (@sammonsonnfl).

Best-ball plan

Anchor the team around Stefon Diggs (board #139, ADP 138.1). Board-vs-market values to exploit: Deebo Samuel Sr. (#172 vs ADP 180.8). Let the market overpay for Tyreek Hill, Nick Chubb.

Risks & flags

No specific risk overlays on this group; the main risk is generic (price vs the field).